

Software Engineering

Lecture 2: Software Development Processes & Methodologies

Prof. Nien-Lin Hsueh

Department of Information Engineering and Computer Science
Feng Chia University

Chapter 2: Roadmap & Key Topics

- **2.1 Process and Process Model**
- **2.2 Plan-Driven Paradigms — Waterfall & the V-Model**
- **2.3 The Mechanics of Change — Incremental & Iterative**
- **2.4 The Mindset Shift — Agile Philosophy**
- **2.5 Agile Project Management — Scrum & Kanban**
- **2.6 The Hidden Cost of Speed — Technical Debt**
- **2.7 Technical Rigor — Extreme Programming (XP)**
- **2.8 Systems & Culture — DevOps**
- **2.9 The Modern Frontier — AI Spec-Driven Process**
- **Recap Quiz & References**

Focus Questions

- What is the fundamental difference between a **software process activity** and a **lifecycle model** (plan-driven vs. evolutionary)?
- How do **incremental delivery** and **iterative refinement** combine to build a **Minimum Viable Product (MVP)**?
- Why is **Agile** an overarching cultural mindset rather than a rigid framework, and how do **Scrum** and **Kanban** apply it?
- How do **XP engineering practices**, **DevOps pipelines**, and **AI spec-driven workflows** guarantee quality and eliminate **Technical Debt**?

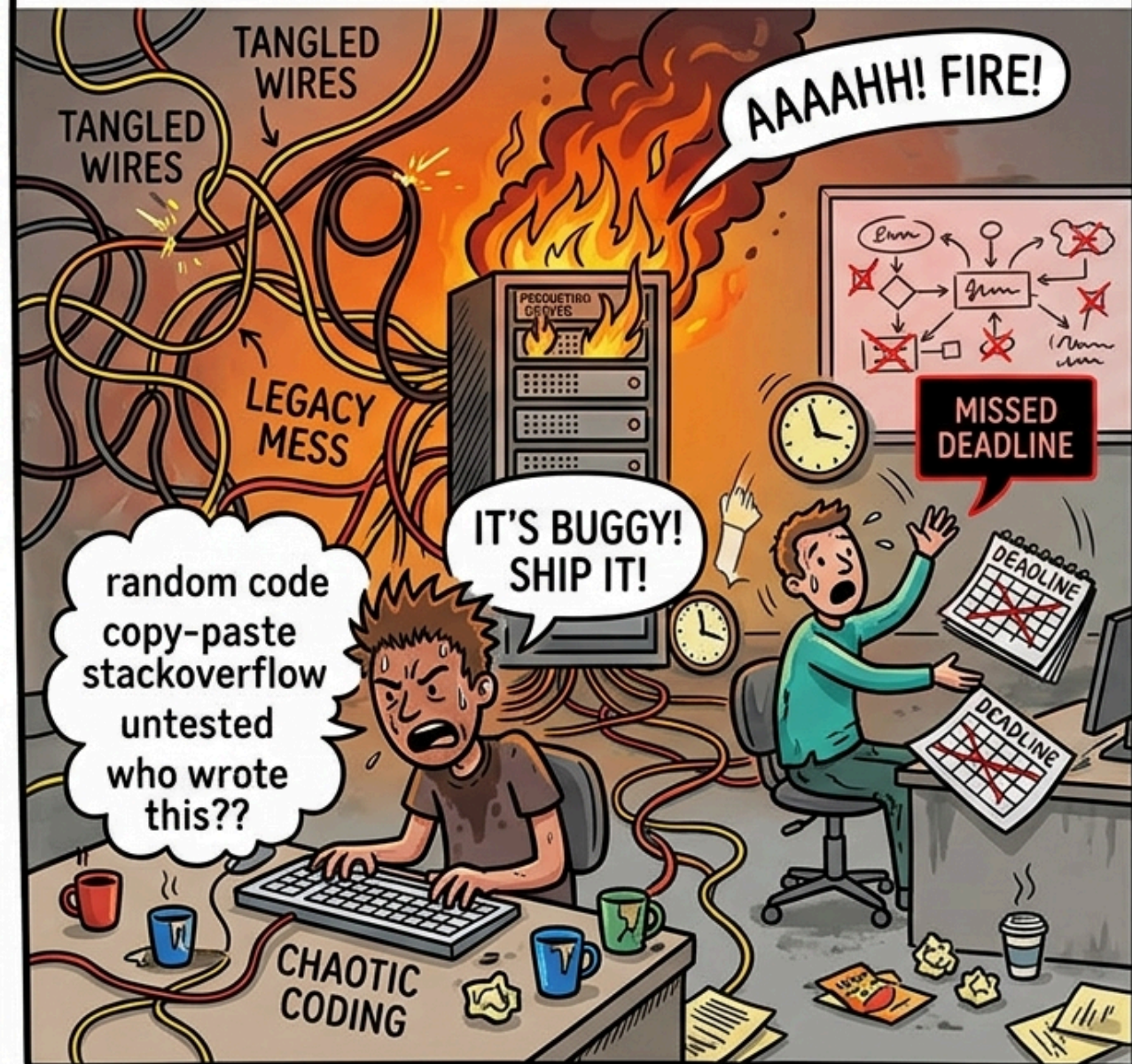
2.1 Process and Process Models

"If a process is not predictable and repeatable, success is merely good luck."

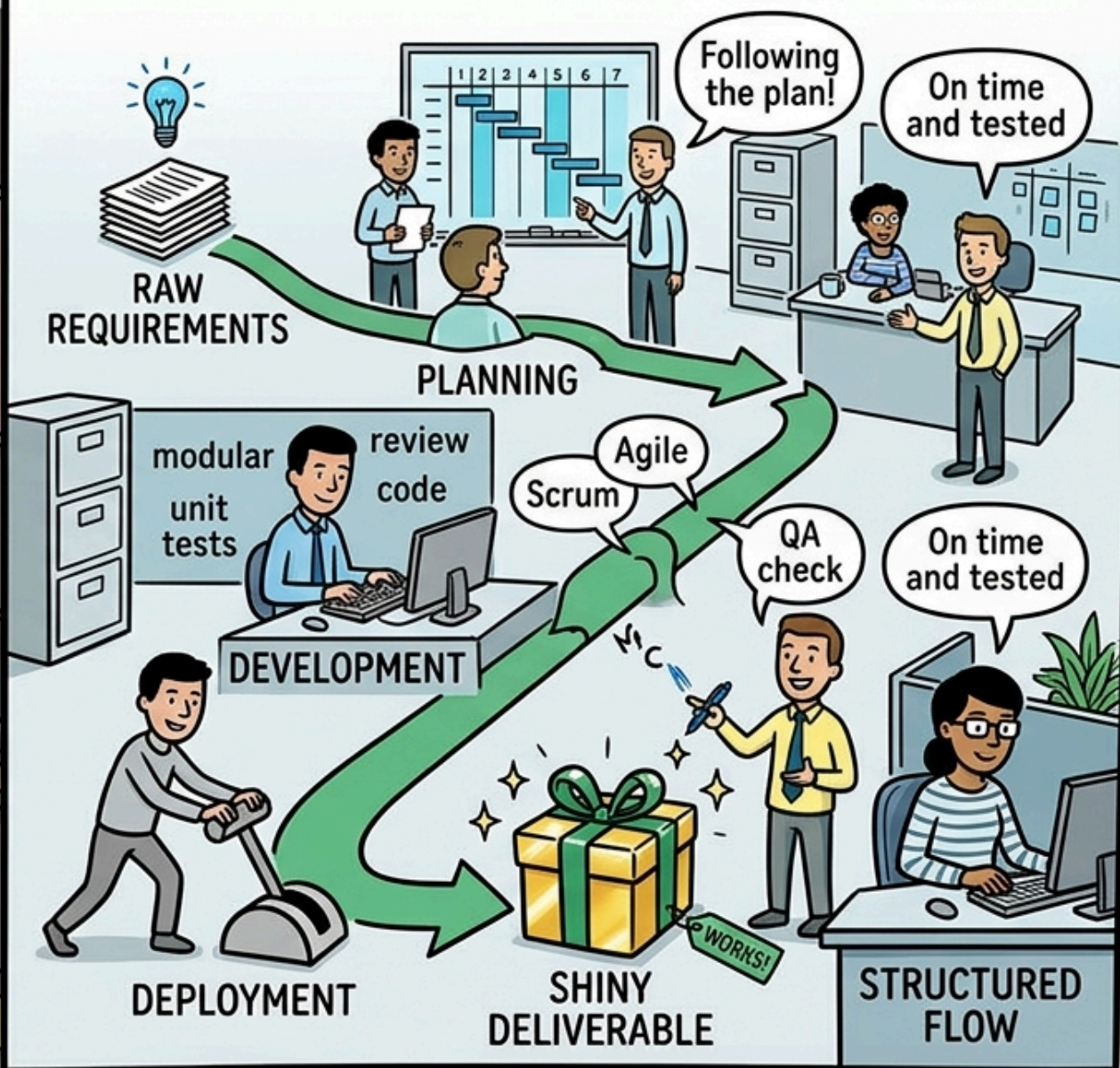
— Watts S. Humphrey

”

WITHOUT A PROCESS



WITH A PROCESS MODEL



Software Development Process & Process Models

- **What is a Software Process? (The Concrete Reality):**

- A structured set of technical, collaborative, and managerial activities carried out to develop, deploy, and maintain software.
- *ISO/IEC 12207 Standard*: "A set of interrelated or interacting activities which transforms inputs into outputs."
- *Ian Sommerville*: "A structured set of activities required to develop a software system."

- **What is a Software Process Model? (The Strategic Blueprint):**

- A simplified, abstract representation or architectural framework of a software process.
- Defines the strategic sequencing of phases, transition criteria (entry/exit gates), roles, deliverables, and risk management policies (e.g., Waterfall, V-Model, Prototyping, Scrum).

- **The Core Distinction:**

- **Process** is *what teams actually do* in practice (time-agnostic activities).
- **Process Model** is the *theoretical blueprint or strategy* chosen to organize, sequence, and govern that work over time.

Universal Process Activities: The 4 Pillars of SDLC

Regardless of which process model you adopt, **all software processes** encompass four universal activities:

1. Software Specification (Requirements Engineering):

- Defining what the system should do, operational constraints, user stories, and acceptance criteria.

2. Software Design & Implementation:

- Architecting structural blueprints and writing executable program code.

3. Software Validation (Verification & Testing):

- Ensuring the software conforms to specifications and satisfies customer expectations.

4. Software Evolution (Maintenance & Operations):

- Modifying, refactoring, and scaling existing software in response to changing user needs.

 **Key Insight:** Activities are time-agnostic actions. **Process models differ fundamentally in WHEN and HOW OFTEN these four activities take place!** ”

Landscape of Popular Software Process Models

- **The Spectrum: From Predictive (Plan-Driven) to Adaptive (Continuous):**
 - **1. Plan-Driven / Sequential Models:**
 - *Waterfall & V-Model:* Comprehensive upfront planning, linear sequential phases, strict milestone gates, and verification traceability.
 - **2. Evolutionary / Risk-Driven Models:**
 - *Spiral Model & Prototyping:* Cyclic spirals guided by explicit risk assessment and rapid exploratory user mockups.
 - **3. Iterative & Incremental Models:**
 - *Incremental Delivery & Agile Methods:* Delivering self-contained functional vertical slices in short, adaptive feedback sprints.
 - **4. Continuous & Spec-Driven Paradigms:**
 - *DevOps & CI/CD Pipelines:* Merging development and operations via automated test, build, and deploy loops.
 - *Specification-Driven AI:* Leveraging LLM coding agents strictly governed by formal specifications and automated verification gates.

2.2 Plan-Driven Paradigms (Waterfall & V-Model)

"Plan the work, then work the plan."

Predictability, stage-gate discipline, and verification traceability. „

Plan-Driven Paradigms — Waterfall & the V-Model

Plan-driven software process models where development proceeds through distinct, structured stages, prioritizing formal upfront planning, stage-gate governance, and verification traceability. „

- **Underlying Philosophy:**

- Borrowed from traditional engineering disciplines (civil, aerospace, manufacturing): complete comprehensive design *before* committing to construction to avoid catastrophic rework.

- **Core Plan-Driven Tenets:**

- **Predictability:** Fixed budgets, fixed timelines, and predefined delivery milestones.
- **Document-Centric Handoffs:** Detailed specifications serve as legally binding boundary contracts between specialized teams.
- **Formal Verification:** Work cannot proceed to the next stage until the current stage passes formal review gates.

The Waterfall Model: 5 Sequential Phases

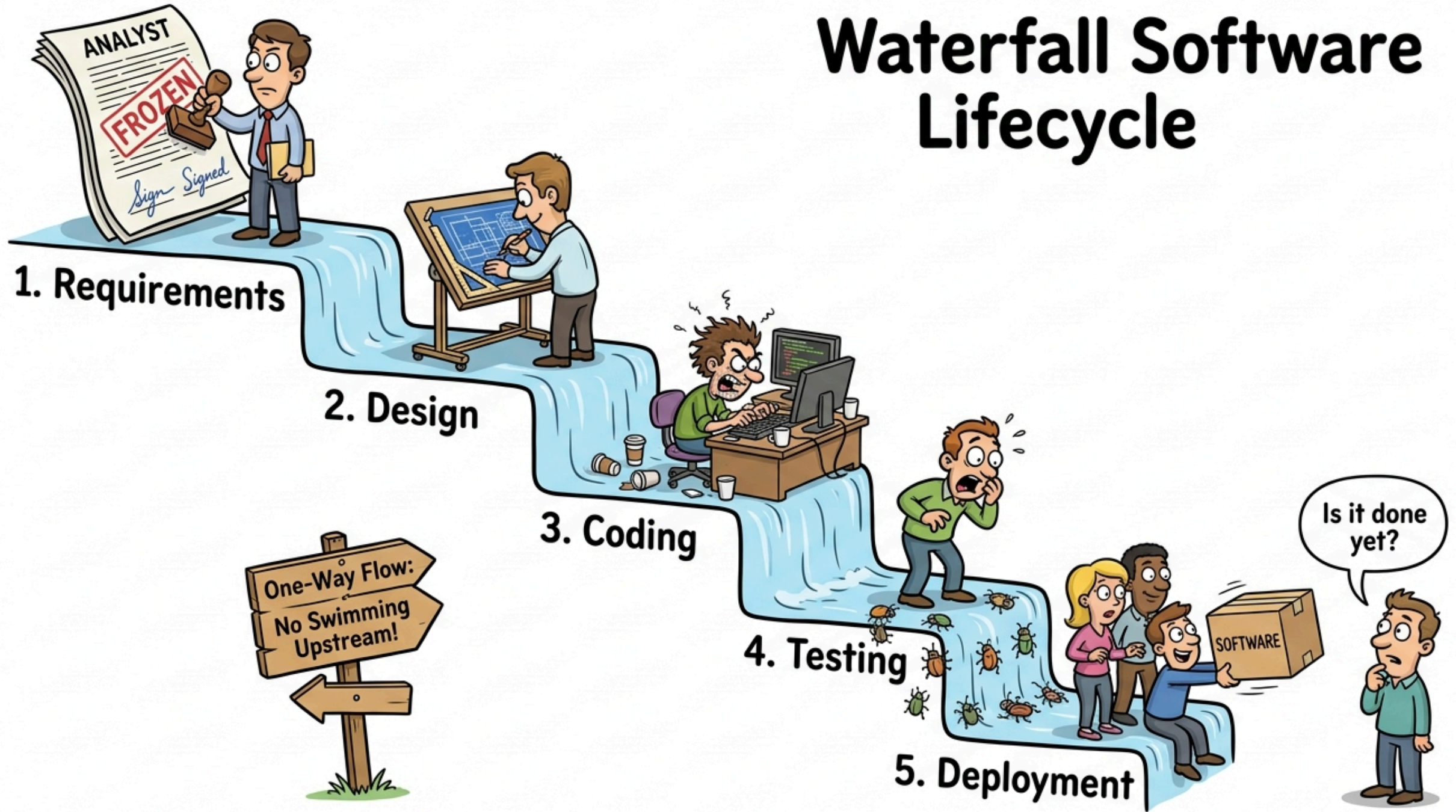
- **Historical Background:**

- First described by **Winston W. Royce in 1970** in "*Managing the Development of Large Software Systems*".
- *Historical Irony:* Royce presented it as an illustration of a risky, flawed process that requires feedback loops and prototyping to succeed!
- Codified by military standards (e.g., DoD-STD-2167A) for large government procurements.

- **The 5 Sequential Phases:**

1. **Requirements Analysis & Definition:** Elicit and freeze the Software Requirements Specification (SRS).
2. **System & Software Design:** Establish overall architecture, data structures, and interface definitions.
3. **Implementation & Unit Testing:** Translate design into code and verify individual modules.
4. **Integration & System Testing:** Assemble modules into an integrated system and verify against the SRS.
5. **Operation & Maintenance:** Deploy to production and patch operational defects.

Waterfall Software Lifecycle



The Waterfall Model: Applicability and Limitations

- **Applicability (Ideal Scenarios):**

- **Stable & Well-Understood Requirements:** Specifications are thoroughly frozen upfront and will not change during development.
- **Safety-Critical & Regulated Domains:** Medical devices, aerospace avionics, and defense systems requiring formal verification and audit traceability.
- **Inflexible Hardware or Multi-Vendor Contracts:** Embedded hardware fabrication constraints or rigid legal stage-gate boundaries across vendors.

- **Limitations (Drawbacks & Risks):**

- **Inflexible to Change:** Accommodating requirement modifications once development has started is extraordinarily expensive and disruptive.
- **Late Risk & Defect Discovery:** System integration and testing occur near the end of the lifecycle; major architectural defects surface late.
- **Delayed Working Software:** End users and customers cannot see or evaluate executable software until the final phase, creating a large visibility gap.

Waterfall in Practice: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

- **Q1: Are phases handed off strictly through documents?**

- *Answer: **Yes.*** Classic Waterfall is plan-driven and document-centric. Formal artifacts (SRS, Architecture Specs, Test Plans) act as the binding contract and handoff mechanism between specialized phase teams (Analysts → Designers → Developers → Testers).

- **Q2: Can we really never go back to a previous phase?**

- *Answer: **In theory, no; in practice, yes, but at great expense.*** When defects or oversights are discovered during testing, teams must backtrack. Revising signed specifications, architectures, and code causes severe delays ("backtracking tax").

- **Q3: When does the customer actually see working software?**

- *Answer: **Only at the very end.*** Customers review documents and diagrams early on, but only interact with executable software in the final integration and testing phase, maximizing late-stage delivery risk.

- **Q4: Is the Waterfall model obsolete today?**

- *Answer: **No.*** It remains the standard in safety-critical, regulated, and hardware-coupled domains (aerospace, defense, medical device firmware) where requirements are physically fixed and formal verification is legally mandated.

Concept Check Question 1 (CCQ 1)

What is the primary operational drawback of the traditional Waterfall model?

- **A.** It produces inadequate documentation for external auditing and compliance.
- **B.** It makes accommodating changing requirements extremely difficult and costly once underway.
- **C.** It eliminates the need for component and system testing during execution.
- **D.** It cannot be deployed across large-scale multi-site engineering organizations.



The V-Model: Proactive Verification and Validation

An extension of the Waterfall model that establishes a direct, symmetrical relationship between each development (specification) phase and its corresponding testing phase.

”

- **Why an "Extension of Waterfall"?**

- It preserves the linear-sequential discipline, stage gates, and upfront documentation of Waterfall.
- *The Key Difference:* Instead of treating testing as a late afterthought, it bends the lifecycle upward into a "V" shape to enforce **early, proactive test planning**.

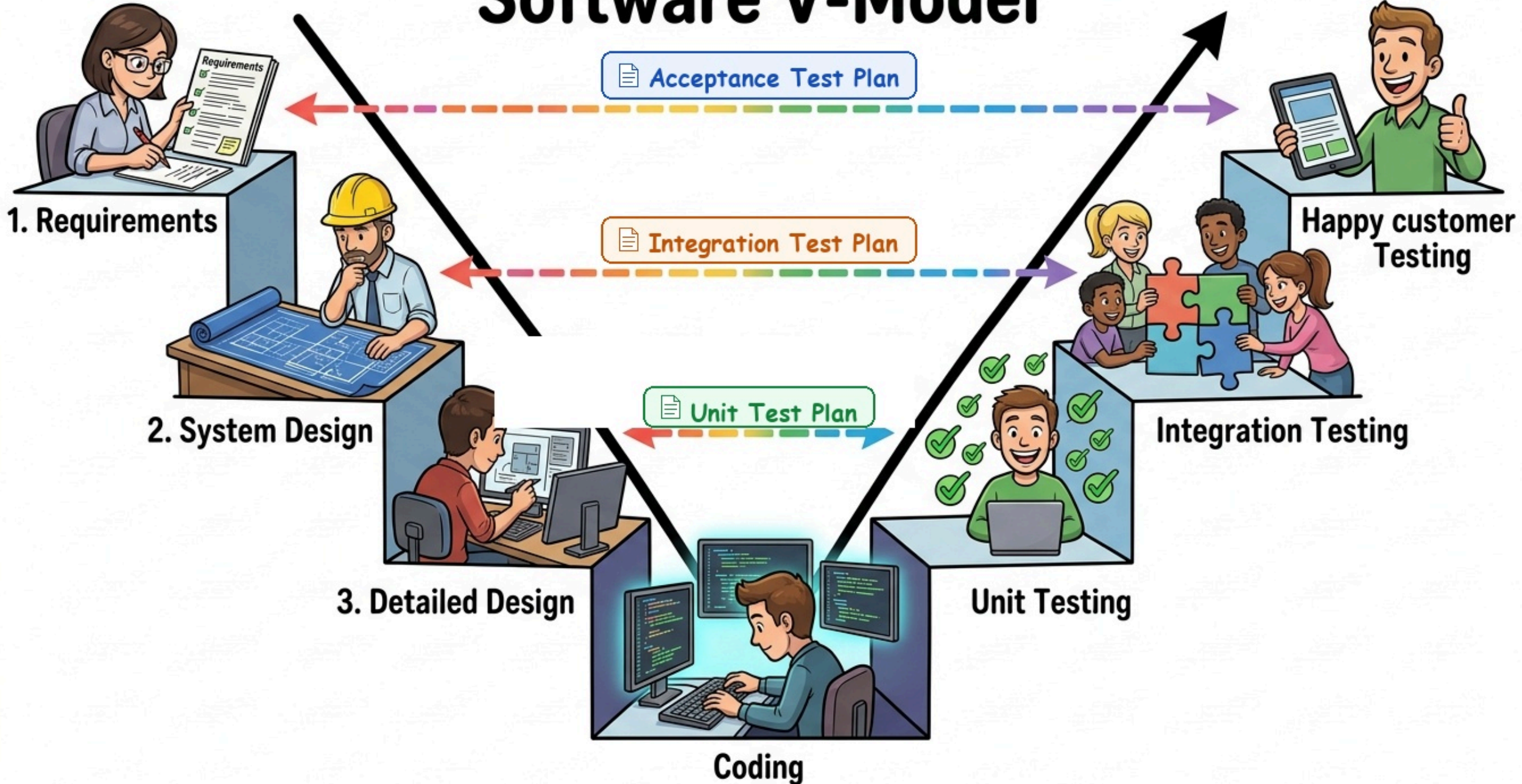
- **Dual-Track Engineering Philosophy:**

- **Left Arm (Decomposition & Design):** Requirements, System Architecture, Component Design.
- **Right Arm (Integration & Validation):** Unit Testing, Integration Testing, Acceptance Testing.
- **The Bottom Vertex:** Source code implementation (Coding).
- *Core Insight:* While writing specifications on the left, engineers simultaneously author the test suites executed on the right!

1. Requirements

Software V-Model

Acceptance Testing



The V-Model Architecture: Traceability & Test Levels

- **The 3 Symmetrical Verification Pairs:**

1. **User Requirements $\longleftrightarrow$ Acceptance Testing:**

- *"Are we building the right system?"* Verifies that business workflows and end-user requirements are completely satisfied before release.

2. **System Architecture $\longleftrightarrow$ System Integration Testing:**

- *"Are subsystems communicating properly?"* Validates API contracts, network protocols, and database integrations against architectural design.

3. **Detailed Component Design $\longleftrightarrow$ Unit / Component Testing:**

- *"Are individual functions working correctly?"* Tests classes, algorithms, and boundary conditions against component specifications.

- **Horizontal Traceability:**

- Establishes a bidirectional requirement traceability matrix: every requirement maps to an acceptance test, eliminating unverified features.

The V-Model: Applicability and Limitations

- **Strengths (The Good):**

- **Proactive Defect Prevention:** Designing test cases during specification exposes ambiguities, contradictions, and omissions before writing code.
- **High Traceability & Auditability:** Explicit 1:1 mapping between design documents and test verification suites.
- **Disciplined Progress Tracking:** Simple to manage with well-defined deliverables at each level of the V.

- **Limitations (The Bad):**

- **Rigid & Intolerant to Change:** Like Waterfall, any requirement modification requires updating both the left-arm specification and the right-arm test suite ("cascading rework").
- **Delayed Executable Software:** No working prototype is produced during the left arm; integration occurs only when ascending the right arm.

- **Applicability (When to Use):**

- Safety-critical, mission-critical, or heavily regulated domains (automotive ISO 26262, aviation DO-178C, medical device FDA) requiring strict verification certification.

Concept Check Question 2 (CCQ 2)

What is the primary engineering advantage of the V-Model over the classic Waterfall model?

- **A.** It produces working software increments in short two-week sprint iterations.
- **B.** It enforces test planning and acceptance criteria design concurrently with early specification phases.
- **C.** It eliminates the need for detailed architecture design and interface contracts.
- **D.** It allows customers to dynamically modify requirements at zero cost during implementation.



2.3 The Mechanics of Change (Incremental & Iterative)

"Incremental delivery gives you pieces early; iterative development refines the whole over time. Together, they build a Minimum Viable Product."

The Mechanics of Change – Incremental & Iterative Development

*An engineering approach that decomposes a complex system into smaller, self-contained functional components delivered in successive stages (**increments**) while progressively refining and deepening capabilities through cyclic feedback (**iterations**).*

”

- **Historical Background & Motivation:**

- Emerged in the 1970s and 1980s (Mills, Basili, Boehm) in direct response to the rigidity, specification freezing, and late-stage defect discovery of the Waterfall model.
- Replaced "Big Bang" release cycles with **continuous, incremental value realization**.

- **Core Engineering Philosophy:**

- **Early Value Realization:** Deliver high-priority, usable subsets to users early rather than waiting for full completion.
- **Empirical Validation:** Validate architectural choices and business assumptions with executable software instead of paper specifications.
- **Feedback-Driven Adaptation:** Real-world user feedback from early increments directly steers subsequent design and development cycles.

Incremental Delivery: Functional Partitioning & Value Staging

- **Vertical Functional Slicing:**

- The system is divided into self-contained vertical slices delivered stage by stage.
- Each increment delivers 100% finished functionality for a specific subset of features (UI + Business Logic + Database persistence).

- **Staging High-Priority Value to Users:**

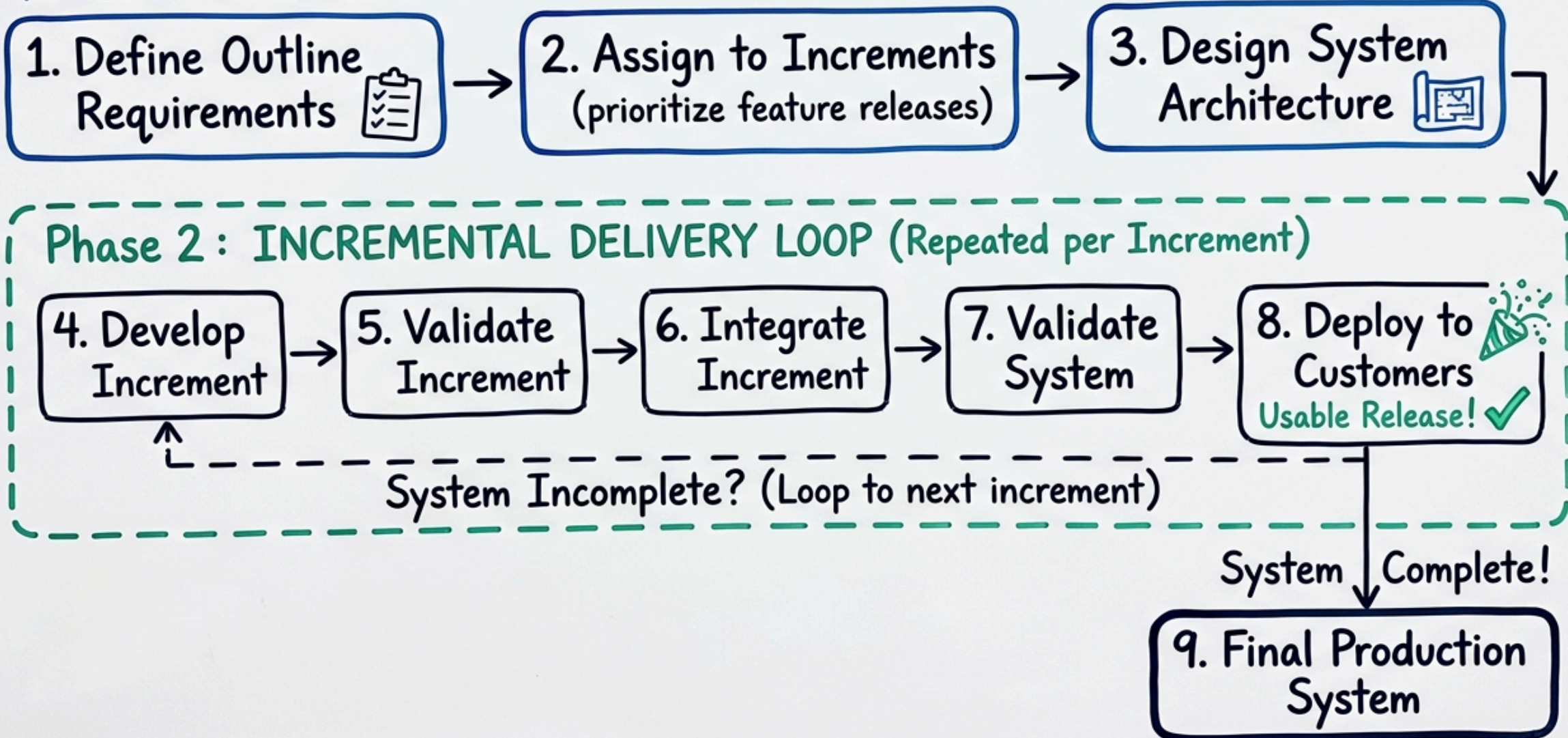
- **Increment 1:** User Registration, Login & Restaurant Menu Search.
- **Increment 2:** Shopping Cart & Online Checkout.
- **Increment 3:** Personalized Recommendation Engine & Analytics.

- **Operational Business Benefit:**

- The customer receives tangible, working business value early, rather than waiting years for a "Big Bang" complete release.

The Incremental Delivery Process

Phase 1 - Architecture



Iterative Development & The Sculptor Analogy

- **Progressive Refinement of the Whole:**

- An incomplete version of the *entire* system is created first, then repeatedly revised, deepened, and polished based on empirical feedback.

- **The Sculptor Metaphor:**

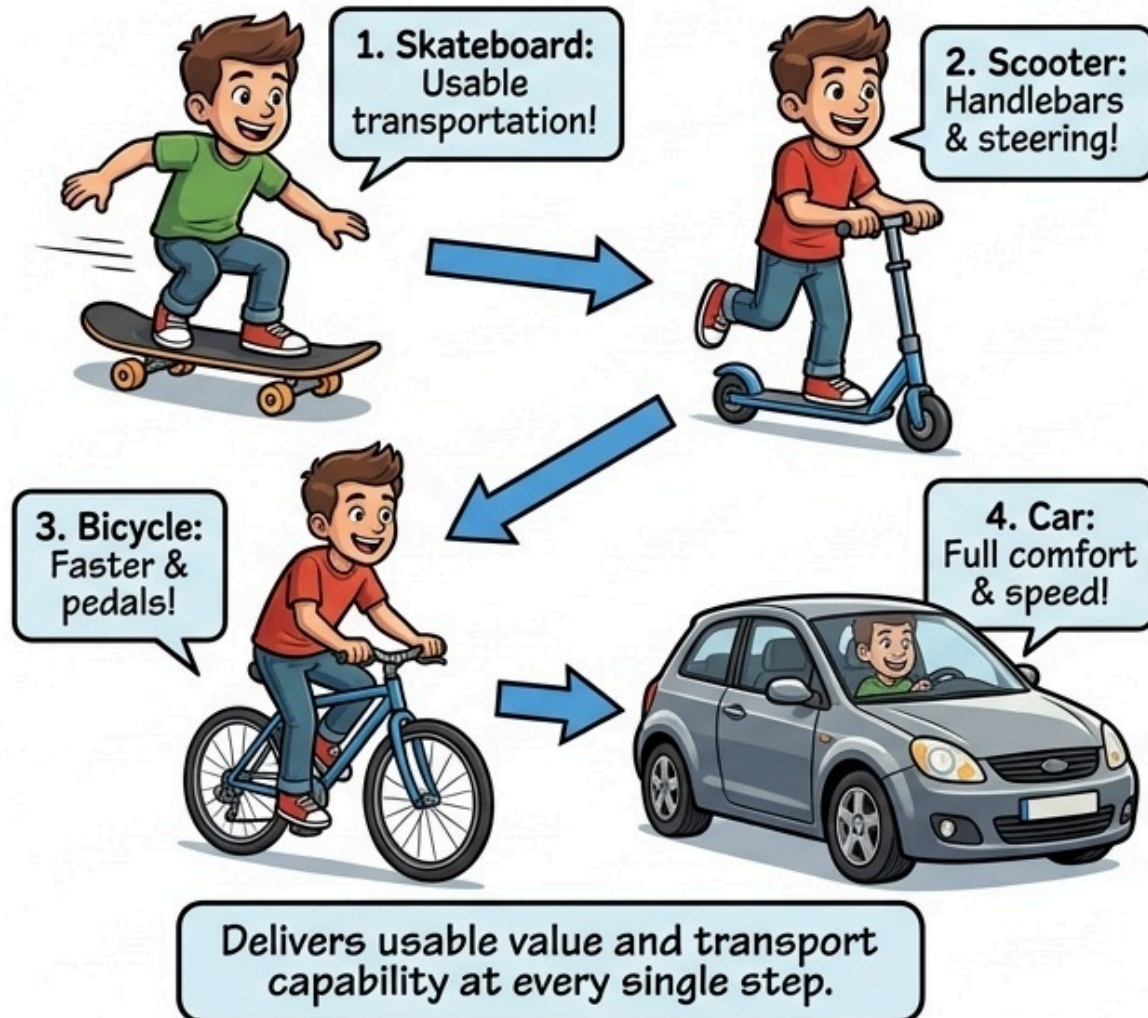
- **Iteration 1 (Rough Silhouette):** Chisel the general shape out of a raw block of marble.
- **Iteration 2 (Proportions & Limbs):** Carve the major muscle groups, limbs, and facial outline.
- **Iteration 3 (Detailing):** Define fine hair, hands, and facial expression.
- **Iteration 4 (Surface Polish):** Smooth the marble surfaces to a polished sheen.

- **Core Takeaway:**

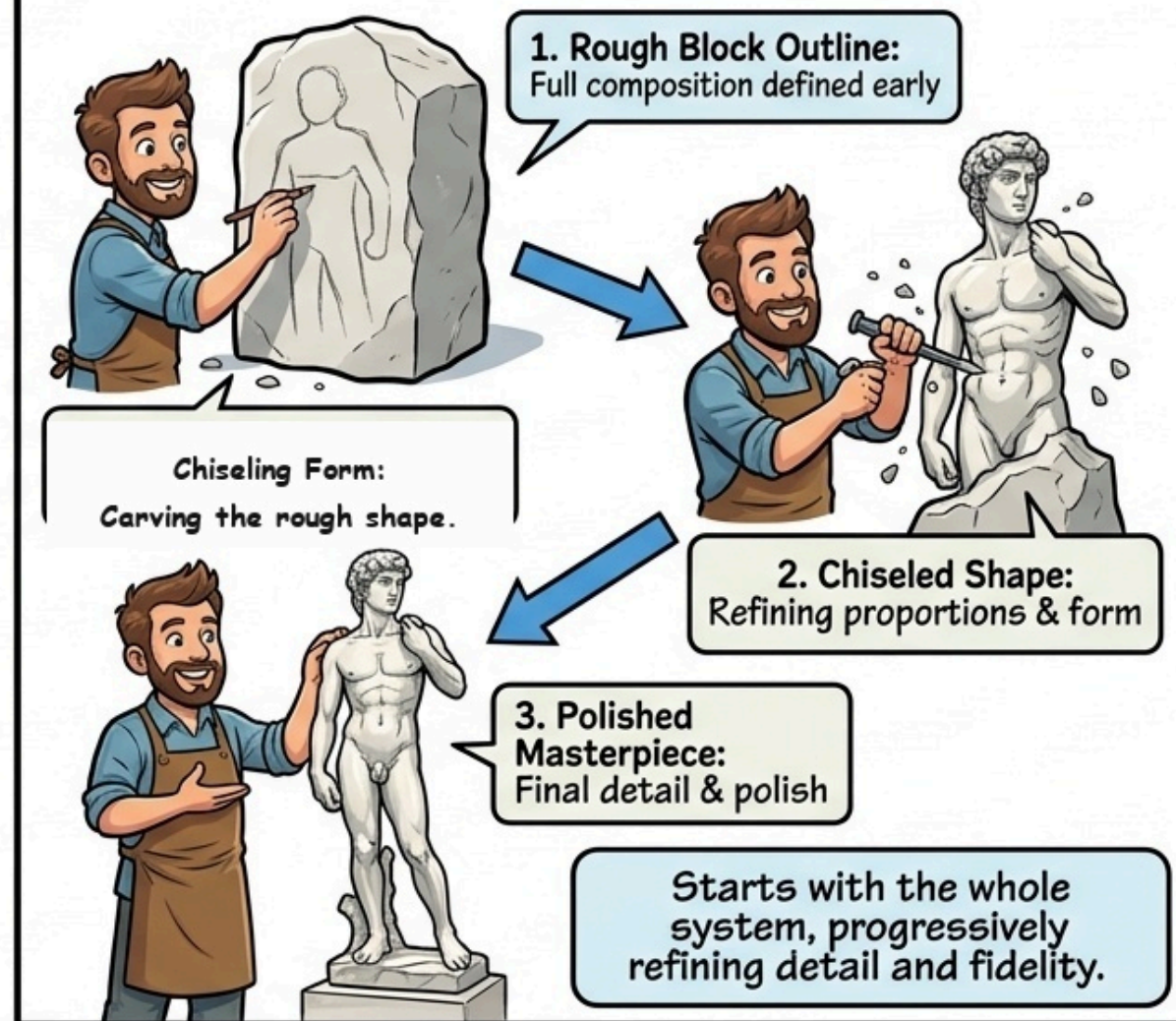
- Every iteration touches and refines the whole product, allowing continuous validation of overall proportions!

Delivering Value vs. Refining Fidelity

The MVP Progression (Incremental Delivery)

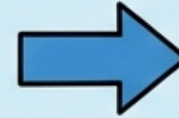
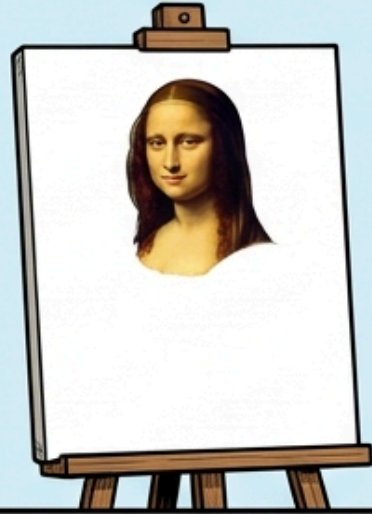


The Sculptor (Iterative Refinement)



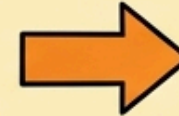
Incremental vs. Iterative: The Mona Lisa Analogy

INCREMENTAL APPROACH (Piece-by-Piece Assembly)



High Risk:
The customer cannot evaluate the overall composition until the very last step.

ITERATIVE APPROACH (Progressive Refinement & Polish)



Low Risk (Agile MVP):
The whole picture is visible on Day 1, allowing early validation and feedback.

Combined Model (Incremental + Iterative) & The MVP

- **Real-World Agility Combines Both Dimensions:**

- Deliver functional slices incrementally, while continuously refining existing slices iteratively based on user telemetry.

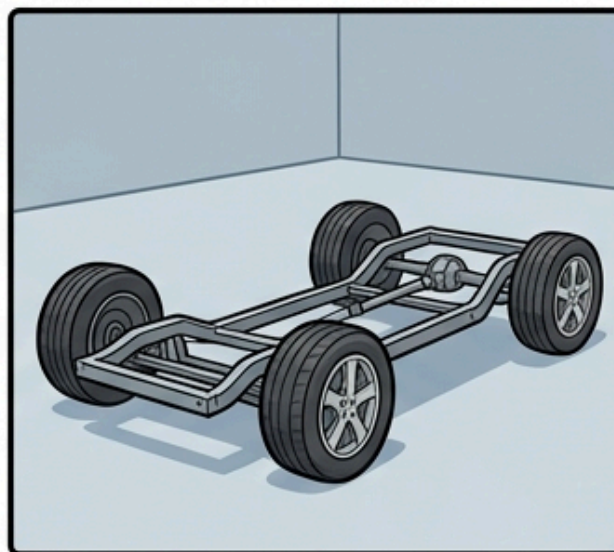
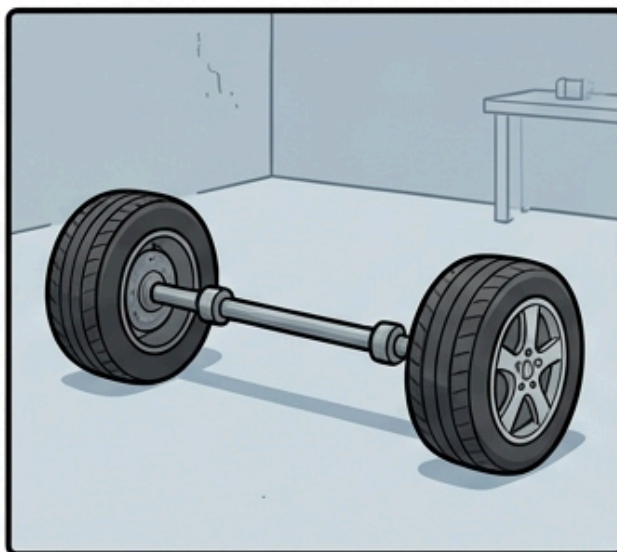
- **The Henrik Kniberg Car Metaphor:**

- *Wrong (Pure Incremental without Usability):* Delivering a Wheel → Axle → Chassis → Car.
 - *(A user cannot commute to work on a detached rubber wheel!).*
- *Right (Combined MVP Progression):* Skateboard → Scooter → Bicycle → Motorcycle → Car.
 - *(Every release provides an end-to-end usable transportation capability!).*

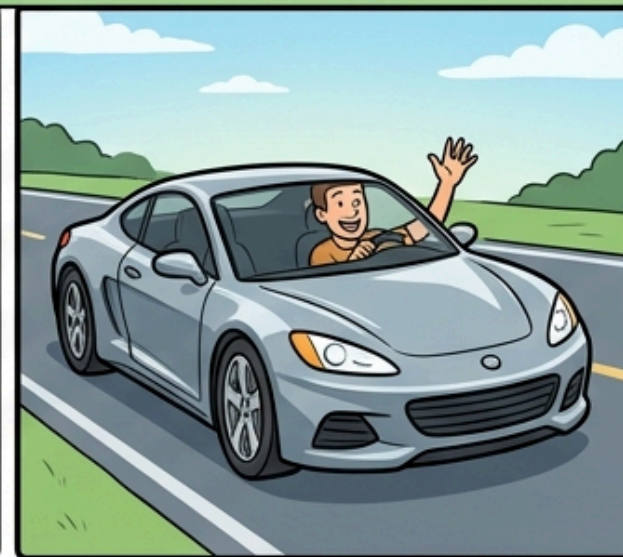
- **Definition of Minimum Viable Product (MVP):**

- The smallest functional product slice that delivers real user value and allows the team to collect the maximum amount of validated customer learning with the least effort.

PURE INCREMENTAL (No Early Value)



COMBINED MODEL: Incremental + Iterative MVP



Can Incremental Be Applied Alone? A Food Delivery Case Study

- **Food Order & Delivery System Example:**

- **Spring 1 (MVP – Core Flow):** Browse simple text menu → Cash on Delivery → Driver phone dispatch.
(Entire vertical flow works!)
- **Spring 2 (Incremental Addition):** Add Online Credit Card Payment slice.
- **Spring 3 (Iterative Refinement):** Upgrade driver phone dispatch to Real-Time GPS Map Tracking.

- **Why Incremental Alone Fails in Modern Software:**

- If you spend 6 months building a pristine restaurant catalog without checkout or delivery, users starve and cannot order food.
- **Architectural Synergy:** Incremental adds new capability boundaries; Iterative deepens quality, performance, and user experience.

Concept Check Question 3 (CCQ 3)

In software process engineering, what is the fundamental conceptual difference between "Incremental" and "Iterative" development?

- **A.** Incremental focuses on automated testing; Iterative focuses on UI design.
- **B.** Incremental delivers finished functional slices stage-by-stage; Iterative progressively refines and deepens an evolving system through repeated feedback cycles.
- **C.** Incremental requires frozen upfront specifications; Iterative eliminates all documentation.
- **D.** Incremental is used solely for hardware; Iterative is used solely for cloud software.



Concept Check Question 4 (CCQ 4)

In Henrik Kniberg's famous Minimum Viable Product (MVP) analogy (Skateboard to Car), why is delivering a standalone car wheel in the first release considered an anti-pattern?

- **A.** Because manufacturing an isolated wheel is significantly more expensive than building a skateboard.
- **B.** Because a detached wheel provides zero usable transportation value and yields no validated user learning.
- **C.** Because a wheel violates standard continuous integration and automated test coverage thresholds.
- **D.** Because a wheel cannot be deployed without prior sign-off from international automotive regulatory bodies.



2.4 The Mindset Shift (Agile Philosophy)

"Responding to change over following a plan."

— *The Agile Manifesto (2001)*

”

CONTRACT NEGOTIATION & BINDERS



WORKING SOFTWARE & COLLABORATION



The Mindset Shift — Agile Philosophy

*Agile is **not** a set of bureaucratic rules, a Jira board, or a collection of meetings. Agile is an overarching **cultural mindset and value system** that prioritizes **individuals, working software, customer collaboration, and adaptability** over **rigid plans**.* ”

- **Historical Context: The 1990s Software Crisis:**

- Massive software projects were failing at alarming rates (Standish Group Chaos Reports: >70% challenged or cancelled).
- Teams spent years producing thick requirement binders while the real-world market moved past them.

- **The Snowbird Summit (February 2001):**

- 17 software pioneers (representing Extreme Programming, Scrum, DSDM, Crystal, Feature-Driven Development) gathered in Snowbird, Utah.
- Despite different methodology backgrounds, they found common ground and drafted the **Agile Manifesto**.

The Agile Manifesto: 4 Core Values

In 2001, the **Agile Manifesto** established four fundamental value pairs:

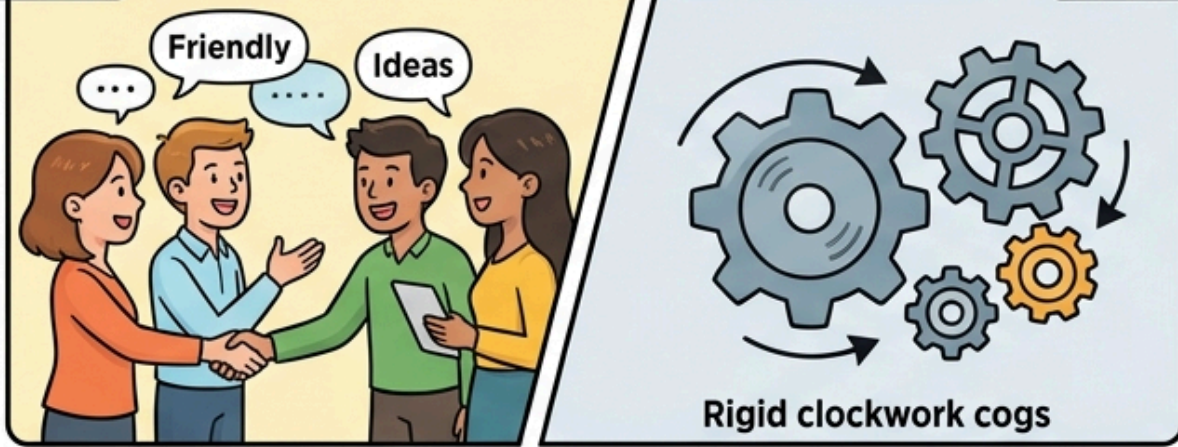
- **Individuals and interactions** over processes and tools
- **Working software** over comprehensive documentation
- **Customer collaboration** over contract negotiation
- **Responding to change** over following a plan

💡 *“That is, while there is value in the items on the right, we value the items on the left more.”* „

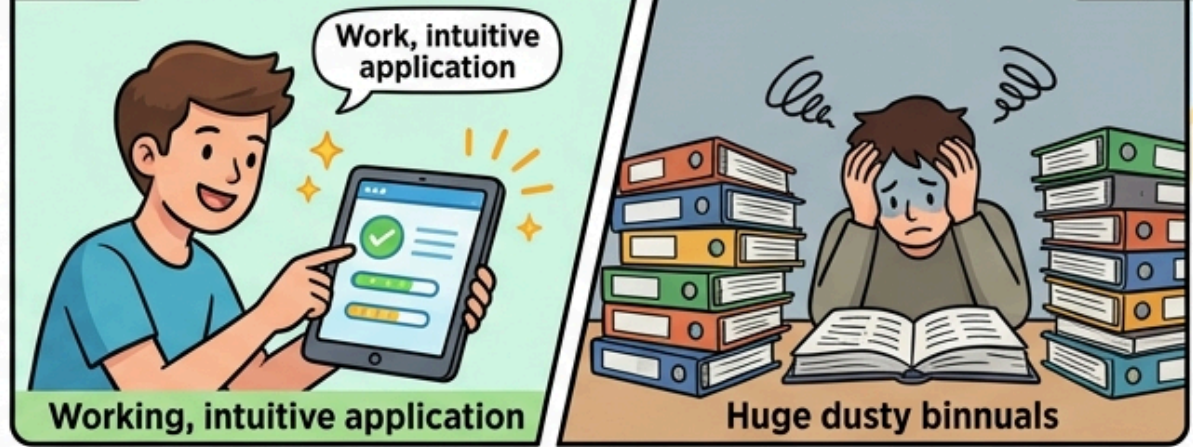
- **The Core Cultural Realization:**

- Processes and tools are useless if developers cannot communicate openly.
- Comprehensive documentation is worthless if the software does not execute.
- Rigid contracts breed adversarial relationships; collaboration builds great products.
- A detailed five-year plan is an illusion in an unpredictable market.

1 Individuals & Interactions over Processes & Tools



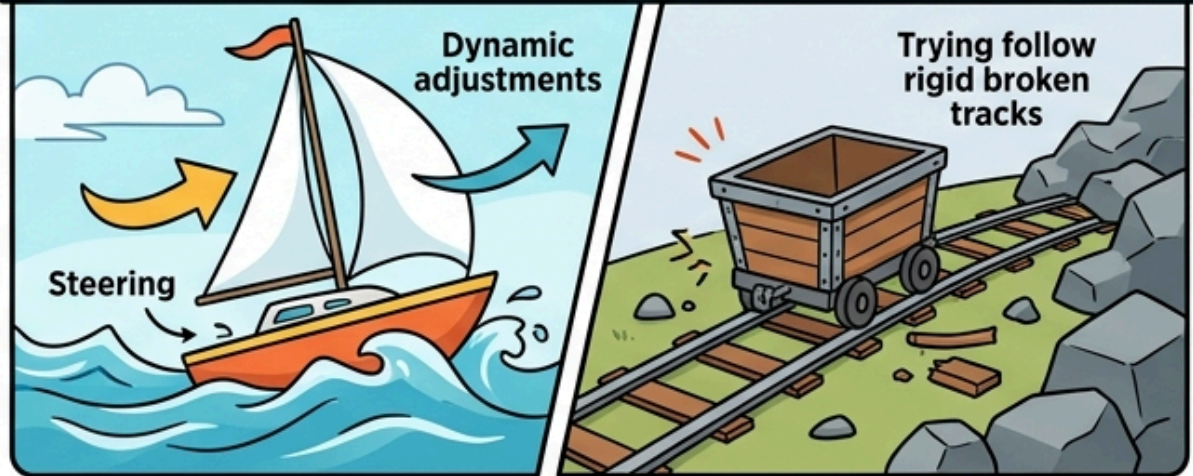
2 Working Software over Comprehensive Documentation



3 Customer Collaboration over Contract Negotiation



4 Responding to Change over Following a Plan



The 12 Principles of Agile Software

1. **Customer Satisfaction:** Satisfy the customer through early and continuous delivery of valuable software.
2. **Welcome Change:** Harness changing requirements for the customer's competitive advantage, even late.
3. **Frequent Delivery:** Deliver working software frequently, from a couple of weeks to a couple of months.
4. **Daily Collaboration:** Business stakeholders and developers must work together daily throughout the project.
5. **Motivated Individuals:** Build projects around motivated people; provide environment, support, and trust.
6. **Face-to-Face Conversation:** The most effective method of conveying information is direct conversation.
7. **Working Software:** Working software is the primary measure of progress.
8. **Sustainable Pace:** Maintain a constant, sustainable development pace indefinitely.
9. **Technical Excellence:** Continuous attention to technical excellence and good design enhances agility.
10. **Simplicity:** The art of maximizing the amount of work not done is essential.
11. **Self-Organizing Teams:** The best architectures, requirements, and designs emerge from self-organizing teams.
12. **Regular Reflection:** Regularly reflect on how to become more effective, then tune and adjust.

Concept Check Question 5 (CCQ 5)

The Agile Manifesto states: "*Working software over comprehensive documentation.*" What does this value primarily advocate in practice?

- **A.** Engineering teams are completely prohibited from writing architecture blueprints or API specifications.
- **B.** While documentation has value, delivering functional software that solves user problems is the primary measure of progress.
- **C.** Software architectures should be created completely ad-hoc during coding without any upfront thought.
- **D.** Documentation should only ever be written if mandated by external government regulatory auditors.



Concept Check Question 6 (CCQ 6)

Agile Principle 8 states: *"Agile processes promote sustainable development. The sponsors, developers, and users should be able to maintain a constant pace indefinitely."* What is the primary engineering motivation?

- **A.** To prevent code quality degradation, accumulated defects, and burnout caused by sustained overtime and 'crunch modes.'
- **B.** To enforce that every developer on the team writes the exact same number of lines of code each day.
- **C.** To ensure that software project budgets remain permanently fixed across all financial quarters.
- **D.** To prevent customers from submitting new feature requests after the first sprint planning session.



2.5 Agile Project Management (Scrum & Kanban)

*"Scrum establishes the cadence; Kanban optimizes the flow.
Stop starting, start finishing."*

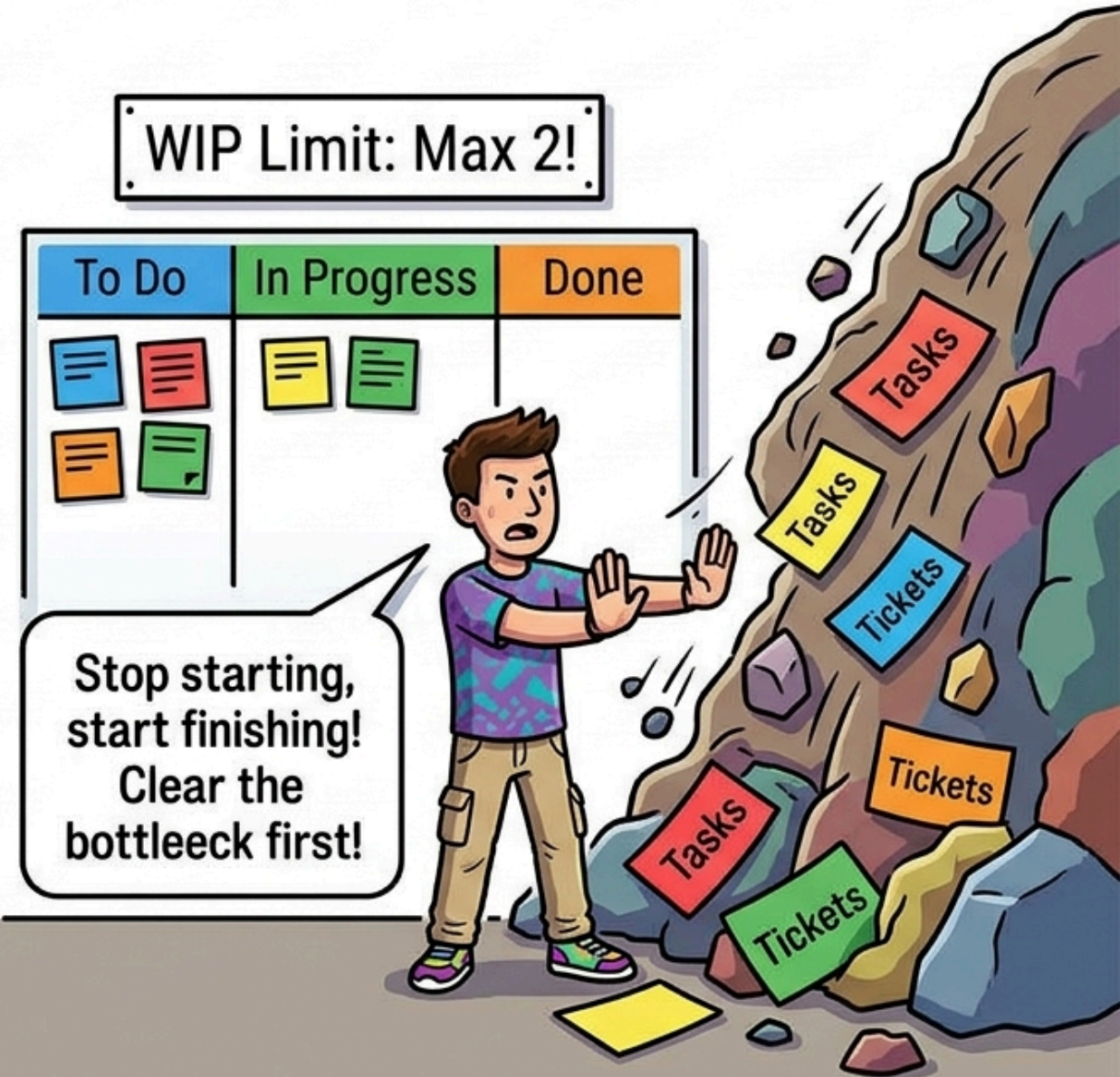
— Henrik Kniberg

”

Scrum: Timeboxed Sprints



Kanban: Continuous Pull Flow



Agile Project Management — Scrum & Kanban

Agile management frameworks organize team collaboration, cadences, and work tracking. They govern HOW WORK IS COORDINATED, but are deliberately silent on how code is engineered. „

- **Why Do We Need Project Management Frameworks?**

- The Agile Manifesto gives philosophy, but doesn't tell a team what to do on Monday morning!
- Teams need concrete mechanisms to prioritize backlog items, synchronize daily efforts, and inspect deliverables.

- **The Two Dominant Management Paradigms:**

- **Scrum:** Timeboxed cadence (Sprints), fixed roles, ceremonies, and committed sprint backlogs.
- **Kanban:** Continuous flow, pull-based delivery, visual cards, and strict Work In Progress (WIP) limits.

The Scrum Framework: Roles & Artifacts

- **Timeboxed Cadences (Sprints):**

- Development cycles of fixed duration (typically 1 to 4 weeks) with inspect-and-adapt reviews.

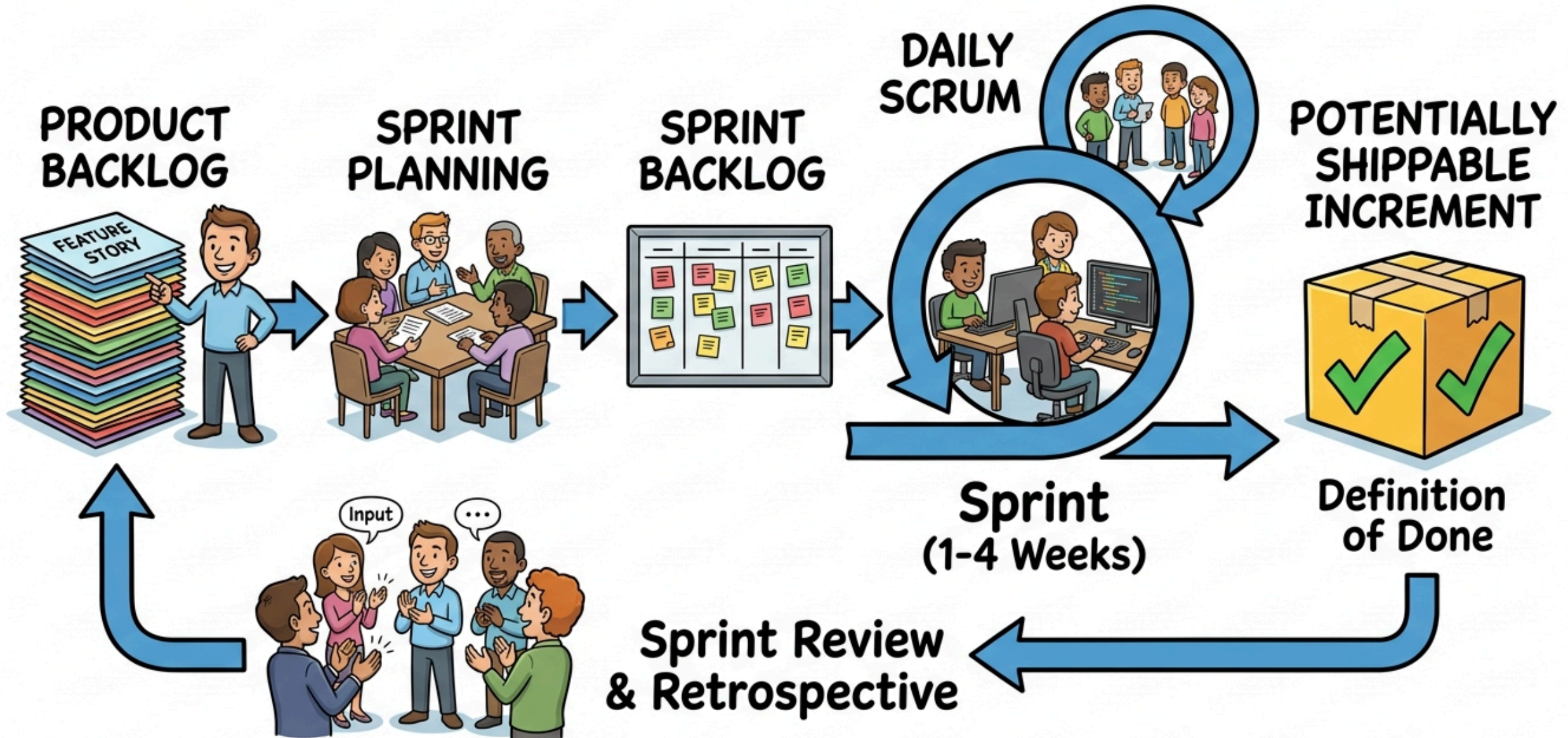
- **3 Defined Roles:**

- **Product Owner (PO):** Defines product vision, prioritizes the backlog, maximizes ROI, represents user voice.
- **ScrumMaster:** Servant-leader; coaches the team, removes impediments, shields developers from distractions.
- **Developers:** Cross-functional professionals who build the releasable increment.

- **3 Core Artifacts:**

- **Product Backlog:** Prioritized single source of truth for all proposed features and fixes.
- **Sprint Backlog:** Committed subset of items selected for the active sprint.
- **Increment:** Usable, tested, and potentially releasable product slice meeting the **Definition of Done (DoD)**.

COMPLETE SCRUM FRAMEWORK LIFECYCLE



Scrum Ceremonies & The Sprint Rhythm

- **1. Sprint Planning:**

- Team inspects the Product Backlog, agrees on a **Sprint Goal**, and selects backlog items into the Sprint Backlog.

- **2. Daily Scrum (Standup):**

- 15-minute daily synchronization meeting:
 - *What did I accomplish yesterday? What will I work on today? What obstacles are blocking my progress?*

- **3. Sprint Review:**

- Held at the end of the sprint to demonstrate the working Increment to stakeholders and gather live feedback.

- **4. Sprint Retrospective:**

- Dedicated team reflection:
 - *What went well? What went poorly? What concrete process experiments will we adopt next sprint?*

The Kanban Framework: Continuous Flow & Pull Systems

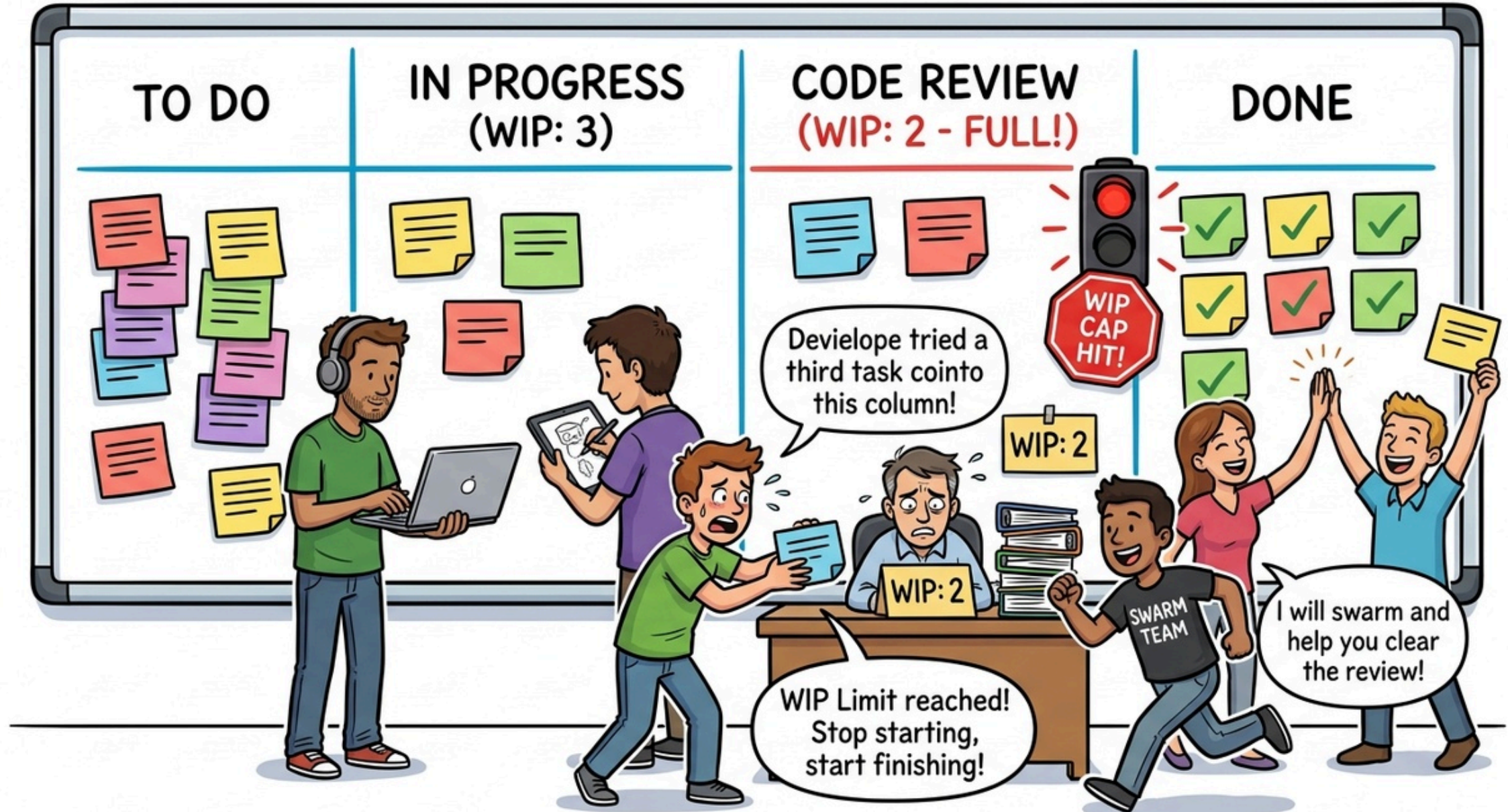
- **Origin & Philosophy:**

- Derived from the **Toyota Production System (Lean Manufacturing)**.
- Instead of fixed timeboxes (sprints), Kanban operates on **continuous flow** through a **pull system**.

- **The 4 Core Practices of Kanban:**

1. **Visualize the Workflow:** Use a Kanban board with distinct columns (To Do, In Progress, Review, Done) to make all work transparent.
2. **Limit Work In Progress (WIP):** Set strict numerical caps on how many tasks can occupy a stage simultaneously.
3. **Manage Flow:** Monitor the movement of items across the board; eliminate blockages.
4. **Make Process Policies Explicit:** Clearly define "Definition of Ready" and "Definition of Done".

The Kanban System: Pull Flow & WIP Limits



Scrum vs. Kanban: Direct Architectural Comparison

Dimension	Scrum	Kanban
Cadence	Regular, fixed-length sprints (1–4 weeks)	Continuous flow; work pulled as capacity allows
Release Timing	At end of each Sprint (or continuous)	Continuous delivery upon task completion
Roles	Product Owner, ScrumMaster, Developers	No prescribed roles (teams keep existing structure)
WIP Control	Limited by Sprint Backlog commitment	Explicit numerical WIP limits per board column
Mid-Cycle Changes	Discouraged during active sprint	Changes can be made to backlog at any time
Primary Metric	Velocity (Story Points per sprint)	Cycle Time, Lead Time, Throughput
Best Suited For	Product development with feature roadmaps	Maintenance, DevOps, IT support, continuous ops

Concept Check Question 7 (CCQ 7)

In the Kanban process framework, what is the primary operational purpose of enforcing strict "Work In Progress" (WIP) limits on columns?

- **A.** To prevent developers from modifying automated unit test scripts.
- **B.** To expose bottlenecks, reduce multitasking, and maximize delivery flow throughput.
- **C.** To mandate that every team member attends daily 15-minute standup meetings.
- **D.** To ensure all software increments are packaged into fixed 2-week sprint iterations.



Concept Check Question 8 (CCQ 8)

In the Scrum framework, what is the primary operational objective of the **Sprint Retrospective** held at the end of each sprint?

- **A.** To demonstrate working software increments to external business stakeholders and end users.
- **B.** To inspect team collaboration, identify operational friction, and commit to concrete process improvements for the next sprint.
- **C.** To evaluate individual developer velocity and determine annual salary adjustments.
- **D.** To re-architect the entire system database schema and deploy hotfixes to live production servers.



2.6 The Hidden Cost of Speed (Technical Debt)

"Shipping first time code is like going into debt.

A little debt accelerates development so long as it is paid back promptly with a rewrite."

— Ward Cunningham

”

Why did our velocity plummet?!

The project is grinding to a halt!

This is great!
It's built so FAST!



The Hidden Cost of Speed – Technical Debt

Shipping code quickly without engineering discipline is like taking out a financial loan. It accelerates delivery today, but incurs compounding interest that eventually bankrupts future engineering velocity.

”

- **The Critical Pivot in Software Engineering:**

- Scrum and Kanban empower teams to move fast and demo features sprint after sprint.
- **The Trap:** What happens when an organization pushes for *speed of feature delivery* while ignoring code quality, architecture, and automated tests?
- **Result:** Development grinds to a halt under a crushing mountain of **Technical Debt!**

- **Origin of the Term:**

- Coined by **Ward Cunningham (1992)**, co-author of the Agile Manifesto and creator of the Wiki:
- *"Shipping first time code is like going into debt. A little debt accelerates development so long as it is paid back promptly with a rewrite... Every minute spent on not-quite-right code counts as interest on that debt."*

The Technical Debt Quadrant (Martin Fowler)

	DELIBERATE	INADVERTENT
PRUDENT	 Prudent & Deliberate "We must ship now and deal with the consequences later" [Strategic Loan]	 Prudent & Inadvertent "Now we know how we should have designed it" [Learning Curve]
RECKLESS	 Reckless & Deliberate "We don't have time for design or tests!" [Toxic Shortcuts]	 Reckless & Inadvertent "What is Layering? Just copy-paste!" [Blind Ignorance]

The "Flaccid Scrum" Phenomenon & Architectural Erosion

- **Martin Fowler's Warning: "Flaccid Scrum"**

- Adopting the superficial management ceremonies of Scrum (standups, sprints, user stories, Jira boards) while **completely ignoring technical engineering practices**.
- Teams become "feature factories" that rapidly produce fragile, untested code.

- **The Consequences of Technical Neglect:**

- **Architectural Erosion:** System boundaries blur, modular encapsulation breaks down, turning clean architecture into a "**Big Ball of Mud**".
- **Velocity Collapse:** Sprint velocity drops exponentially over time because developers spend 80% of their day fighting regression defects.
- **Developer Burnout & Turnover:** High friction, fear of touching code, and morale collapse.

⚠ ***The Fundamental Takeaway:*** *Project management (Scrum/Kanban) without engineering rigor (XP/TDD) is a recipe for project death!* ”

Concept Check Question 9 (CCQ 9)

According to Ward Cunningham's Technical Debt metaphor, what represents the "compounding interest" paid by a software organization?

- **A.** The annual licensing fees paid for cloud hosting infrastructure and IDEs.
- **B.** The ongoing extra time, degraded velocity, and regression defects suffered during all future development.
- **C.** The bonus compensation paid to engineers who complete sprint tickets ahead of schedule.
- **D.** The legal costs of acquiring open-source third-party dependencies.



Concept Check Question 10 (CCQ 10)

Martin Fowler coined the term "**Flaccid Scrum**" to describe which critical software engineering failure?

- **A.** Adopting Scrum management ceremonies (daily standups, sprints, story points) while completely neglecting technical engineering practices like TDD, refactoring, and CI.
- **B.** Refusing to use Jira or commercial issue tracking software in favor of physical sticky notes.
- **C.** Allowing product owners to adjust backlog priorities between sprint planning sessions.
- **D.** Enforcing automated test execution on every Git commit in the continuous integration pipeline.



2.7 Technical Rigor (Extreme Programming)

*"Any fool can write code that a computer can understand.
Good programmers write code that humans can understand."
— Martin Fowler*

”

TDD: Red, Green, Refactor

Driver
(Typing tests & code)

Navigator
(Catching bugs & architecting)

Continuous Refactoring

Navigator
(Catching bugs & architecting)



Technical Rigor — Extreme Programming (XP)

Created by Kent Beck in 1996, Extreme Programming is an Agile process model focused specifically on CODING DISCIPLINE, TECHNICAL EXCELLENCE, and CONTINUOUS REFACTORING — serving as the primary antidote to Technical Debt.

”

- **Why "Extreme" Programming?**

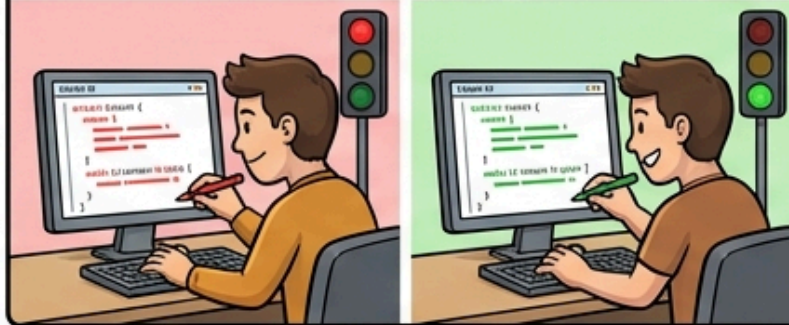
- Kent Beck asked: *"If a software engineering practice is good, what happens if we turn the dial up to 10 and do it all the time?"*
 - If unit testing is good, everyone writes tests continuously (**Test-Driven Development**).
 - If code review is good, we review code every second in real time (**Pair Programming**).
 - If design is good, we refactor and simplify design on every commit (**Continuous Refactoring**).
 - If integration testing is good, we integrate several times a day (**Continuous Integration**).
 - If short iterations are good, releases should be tiny (**Small Releases**).

Core Extreme Programming (XP) Practices

1. Pair Programming



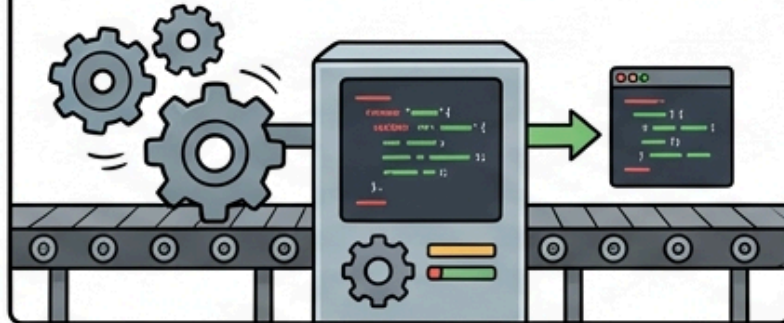
2. Test-Driven Development (TDD)



3. Continuous Refactoring



4. Continuous Integration (CI)



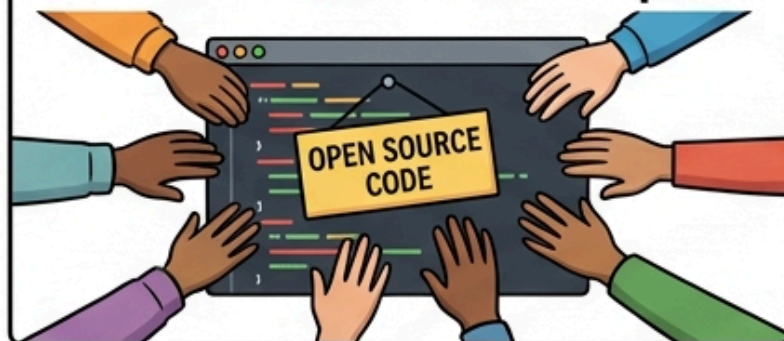
5. Simple Design



6. Small Releases



7. Collective Ownership



8. Sustainable Pace



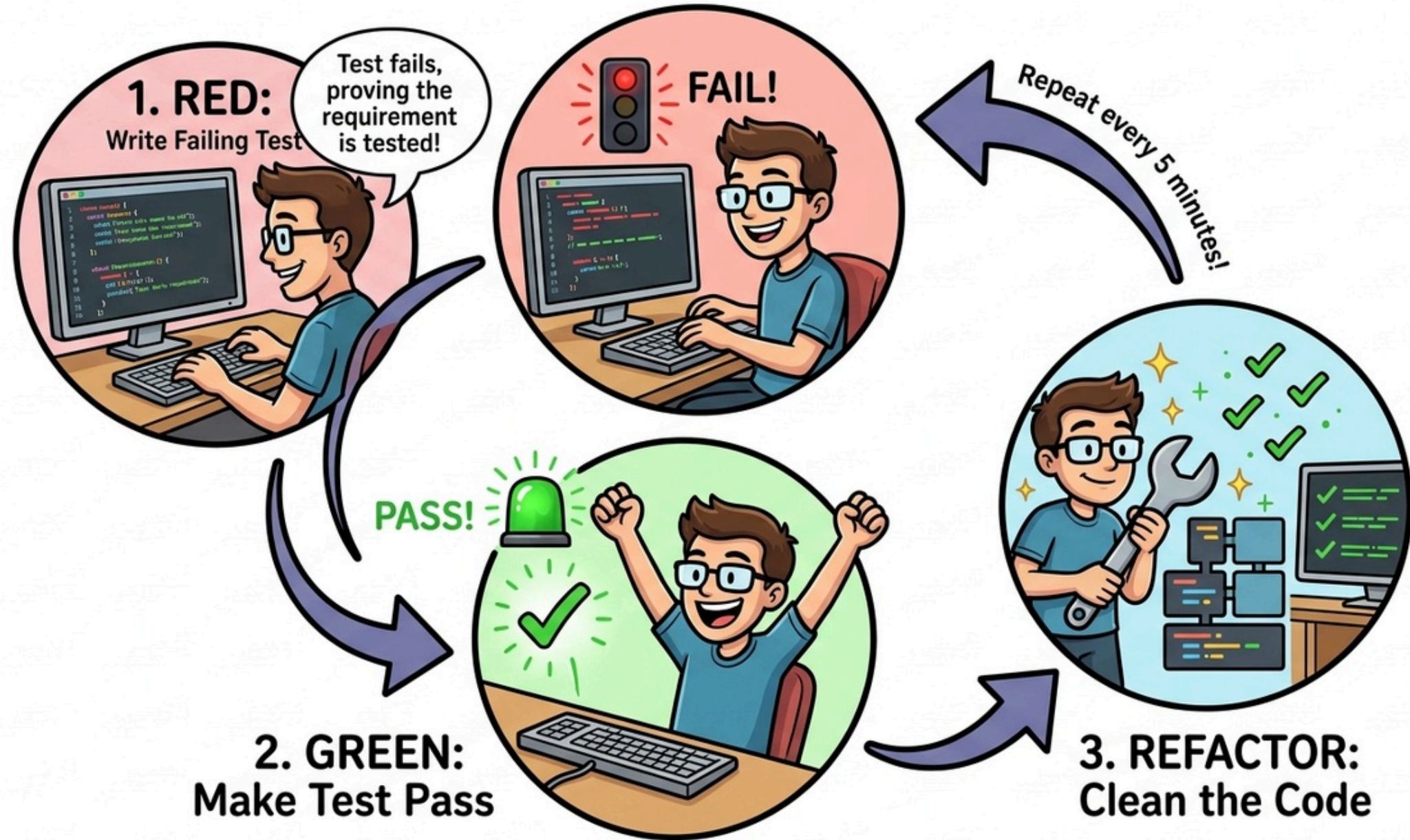
9. On-Site Customer



XP Practices: Test-Driven Development (TDD)

- **The Test-First Mindset:**
 - Never write a line of production code unless you have a failing automated test!
- **The Red-Green-Refactor Cycle:**
 1. **RED:** Write a small automated unit test that specifies desired behavior and fails.
 2. **GREEN:** Write the absolute minimal production code necessary to pass the test.
 3. **REFACTOR:** Clean up structure, remove duplication, and improve names while tests remain green.
- **Result:** Creates an automated regression safety net that makes code changes fearless!

The Test-Driven Development (TDD) Cycle



Continuous Refactoring & Simple Design

- **What is Refactoring?**

- Martin Fowler: *"A change made to the internal structure of software to make it easier to understand and cheaper to modify, without changing its observable external behavior."*
- In XP, refactoring is not a special phase scheduled once a year; **it is an hourly developer reflex.**

- **Kent Beck's 4 Rules of Simple Design:**

1. **Passes all tests:** System correctness is verified automatically.
2. **Reveals intent:** Code is self-documenting with clear naming and modular responsibilities.
3. **No duplication (DRY):** "Don't Repeat Yourself" — single point of truth for business logic.
4. **Fewest elements:** No speculative over-engineering, unused abstractions, or dead code.

- **The Antidote to Debt:** Continuous refactoring constantly repays technical debt on every commit!

Pair Programming & Collective Code Ownership

- **Pair Programming Dynamics:**

- Two developers work side-by-side on a single workstation:
 - **The Driver:** Hands on the keyboard; focuses on tactical syntax, algorithms, and immediate unit tests.
 - **The Navigator:** Observes; focuses on strategic architecture, edge cases, security flaws, and simplification.

- **Collective Code Ownership:**

- No single developer "owns" or hoards a module.
- Any pair can refactor and improve any code anywhere in the repository at any time!

- **Empirical Evidence:**

- Studies show pairing reduces defects by 15–30%, produces cleaner designs, and eliminates the "bus factor".

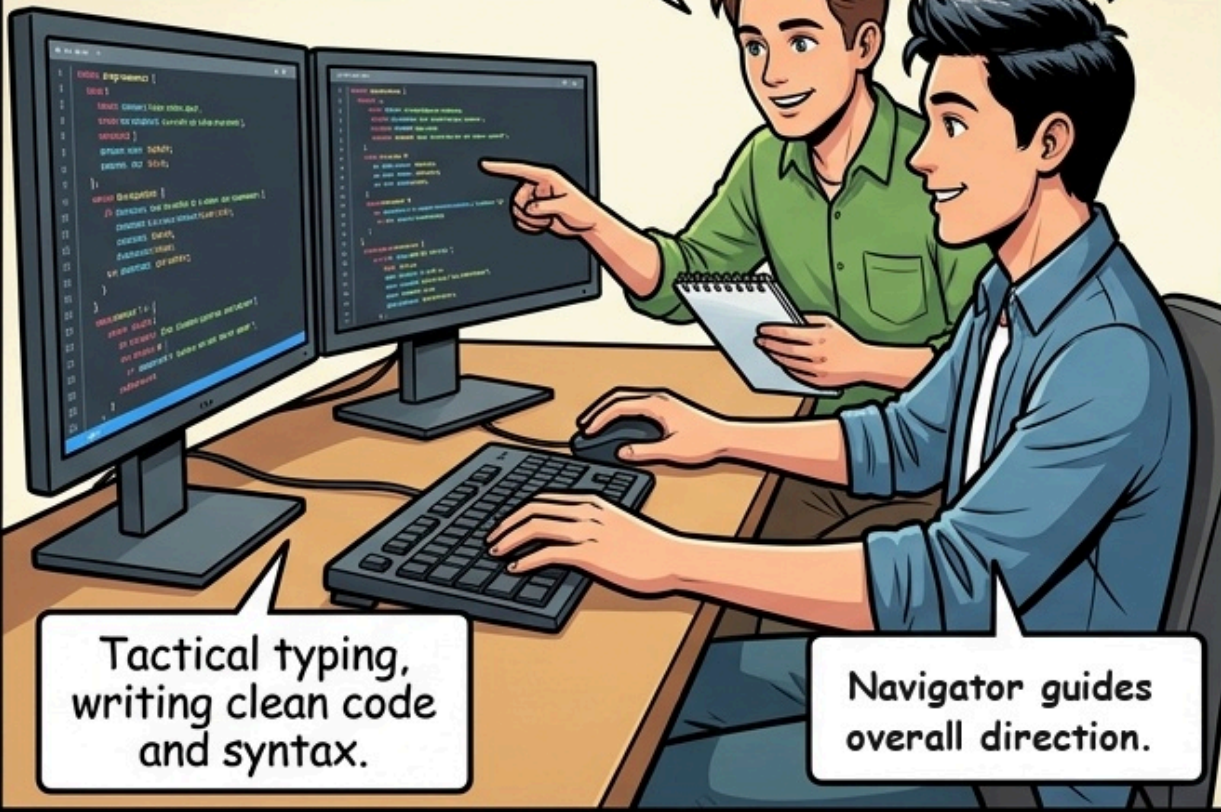
Pair Programming: Driver & Navigator

At the Coding Desk

Tactically typing,
writing clean code
and syntax

What if user
input is null
here?

Good catch!
Adding unit
test now.



Tactical typing,
writing clean code
and syntax.

Navigator guides
overall direction.

The Driving Analogy

Controls the vehicle
and mechanics

Turn left
at the next
junction.

Got it, route
looks clear!



Plans the route and
watches upcoming
turns

Focuses on steering,
pedals & driving.

Concept Check Question 11 (CCQ 11)

In Extreme Programming (XP), what is the primary role of the "Navigator" during a pair programming session?

- **A.** Typing out code syntax and executing local terminal commands.
- **B.** Thinking strategically, reviewing code in real time, considering edge cases, and looking at the broader architecture.
- **C.** Serving as the official sprint facilitator and managing Jira backlog ticket status.
- **D.** Negotiating customer contracts and approving annual engineering budgets.



Concept Check Question 12 (CCQ 12)

In Extreme Programming's Test-Driven Development (TDD), what is the specific objective of the "**Refactor**" step in the Red-Green-Refactor cycle?

- **A.** Adding new functional capabilities and expanding the module's public API contract.
- **B.** Improving the internal structure and readability of the code while ensuring all existing automated tests continue to pass.
- **C.** Removing unit tests that take longer than one second to execute in the local test suite.
- **D.** Rewriting the application from an object-oriented language to a functional programming language.



2.8 Systems & Culture (DevOps)

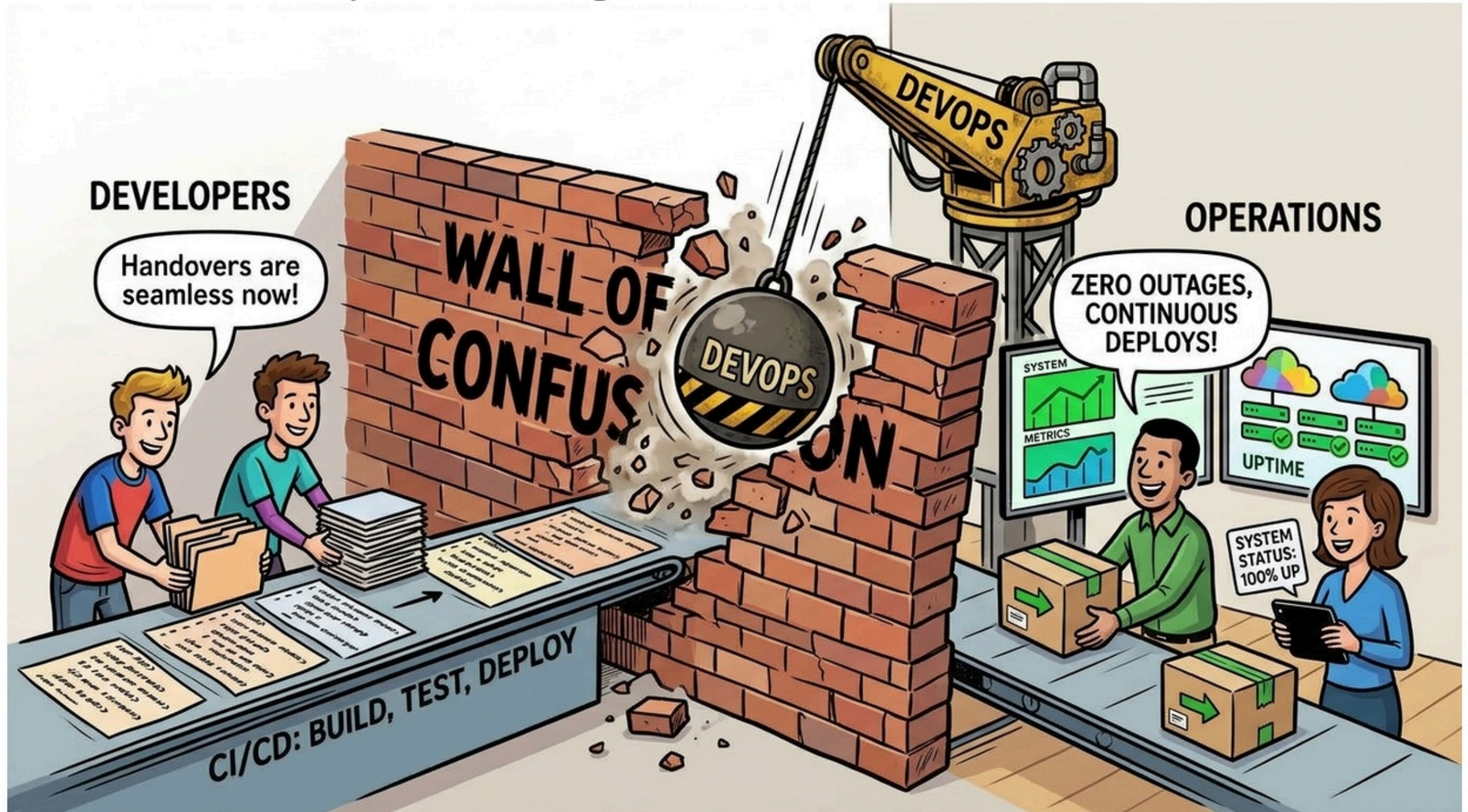
"You build it, you run it."

Breaking down the wall of confusion through continuous delivery and shared operational ownership.

— Werner Vogels, CTO of Amazon

”

DevOps: Breaking Down the Wall of Confusion



Systems & Culture — DevOps

*A **cultural, organizational, and technical movement** that bridges the traditional divide between **Development (Dev)** and **Operations (Ops)**, automating the software delivery lifecycle through **continuous pipelines**, **Infrastructure as Code (IaC)**, and **production telemetry**.* „

- **Breaking the "Wall of Confusion":**

- **Development Incentives:** Rewarded for change, rapid feature velocity, and new releases.
- **Operations Incentives:** Rewarded for stability, uptime, 99.999% reliability, and minimizing changes.
- **The Wall:** Devs threw compiled binaries over the wall to Ops: *"It worked on my machine; now it's your problem!"*
- **The DevOps Solution:** Shared accountability — *"You build it, you run it!"*

Continuous Integration (CI): Automated Quality Gates

- **The CI Discipline:**

- Developers merge their code into a shared mainline repository (**trunk**) multiple times a day.

- **The Automated CI Pipeline (Triggered on Every Git Push):**

1. **Automated Checkout & Build:** Pull latest commit and compile binaries/assets.
2. **Automated Unit & Integration Tests:** Run thousands of automated tests in an isolated runner (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI).
3. **Static Analysis & Security Scans:** Run linters (ESLint, SonarQube) and dependency vulnerability checkers (Snyk).

- **The Fundamental CI Rule:**

- If ANY test fails, the build is **BROKEN**.
- The team must immediately halt new feature work and fix the build. The mainline branch is always green!

Continuous Delivery vs. Continuous Deployment (CD)

- **Continuous Delivery:**

- Every passing build automatically generates a validated, release-ready artifact staged in a production-like environment.
- **Manual Gate:** Deployment to live production is triggered by a **business decision** (clicking a button).

- **Continuous Deployment:**

- Eliminates all human gatekeepers!
- Every commit that passes automated testing and security gates is **automatically deployed to live production** within minutes!
- Requires comprehensive automated test suites, canary rollouts, and real-time observability!

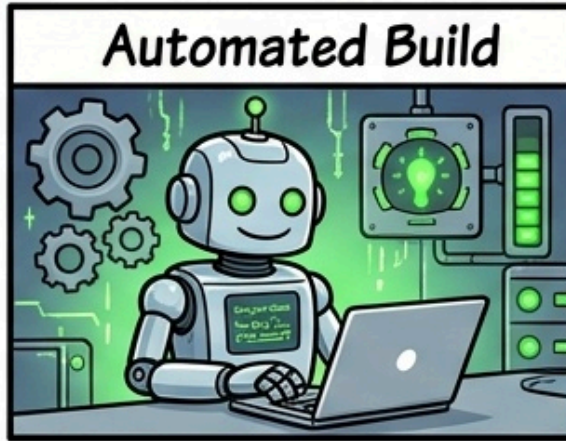
DevOps CI/CD Pipeline: From Commit to Production

CONTINUOUS INTEGRATION (CI)

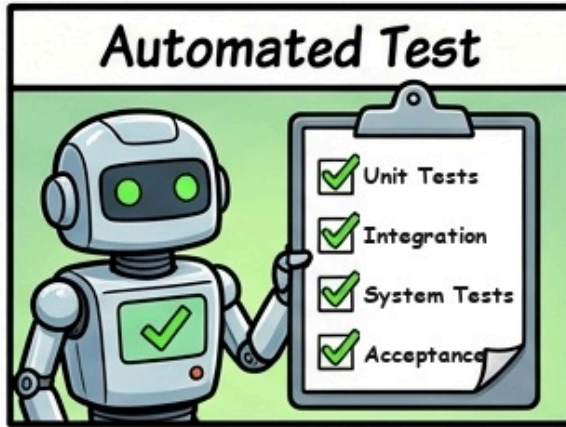
Code & Commit



Automated Build

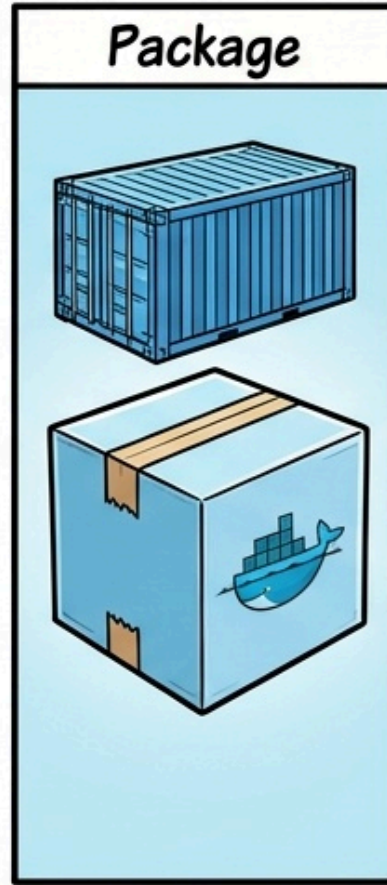


Automated Test

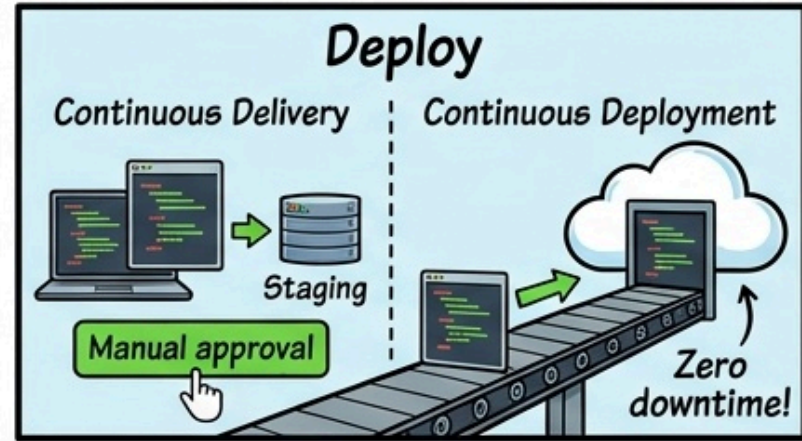


CONTINUOUS DELIVERY & DEPLOYMENT (CD)

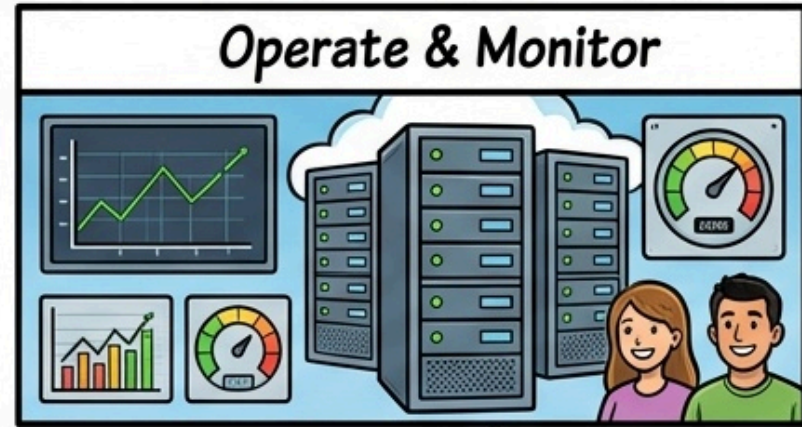
Package



Deploy



Operate & Monitor



Continuous Feedback Loop

Infrastructure as Code & Production Telemetry

- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):**

- Managing cloud infrastructure (servers, networks, databases, Kubernetes clusters) using **declarative code files** version-controlled in Git (Terraform, Ansible, Docker).
- Infrastructure becomes reproducible, testable, and automated—eliminating manual server configuration drift.

- **Production Observability & Feedback Loops:**

- **The Three Pillars of Observability:**

- **Logs:** Structured event records detailing system activities.
- **Metrics:** Numerical timeseries data (CPU usage, memory, latency, requests per second).
- **Distributed Traces:** Tracking a single user request across dozens of microservices.
- Extends the SDLC into live operations, feeding real-world crash reports and telemetry back to engineers.

DORA Metrics: Measuring Velocity & Stability

Established by Google's DevOps Research and Assessment (DORA) team, **four core metrics** differentiate elite engineering organizations from low performers:

- **Velocity / Throughput Metrics:**

1. **Deployment Frequency (DF):** How often does the organization successfully release code to production? *(Elite: Multiple deploys per day).*
2. **Lead Time for Changes (LTTC):** How long does it take for a commit to go from code check-in to running in production? *(Elite: Less than one hour).*

- **Stability / Reliability Metrics:**

3. **Change Failure Rate (CFR):** What percentage of deployments cause production outages or require hotfixes? *(Elite: 0% to 15%).*
4. **Failed Deployment Recovery Time (MTTR):** How long does it take to restore service when a production incident occurs? *(Elite: Less than one hour).*

💡 **DORA Discovery:** Elite teams do NOT sacrifice stability for speed. **High velocity and high stability reinforce each other!**

”

Concept Check Question 13 (CCQ 13)

What is the defining operational distinction between "Continuous Delivery" and "Continuous Deployment"?

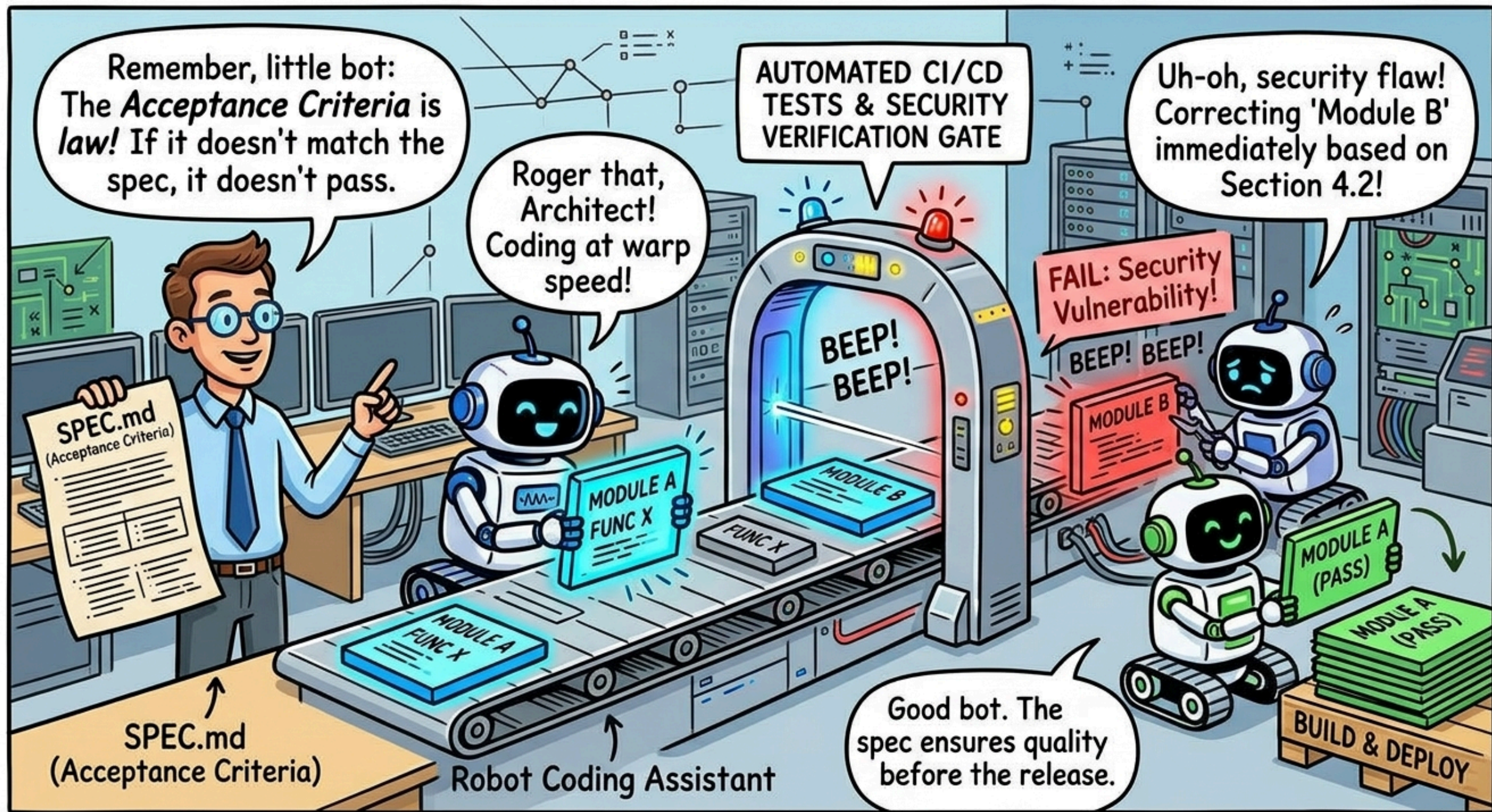
- **A.** Continuous Delivery requires manual code compilation; Continuous Deployment automates compilation.
- **B.** Continuous Delivery stops at staging and requires human business approval to release; Continuous Deployment automatically deploys passing builds directly to live production.
- **C.** Continuous Delivery is used solely for mobile apps; Continuous Deployment is used solely for backend databases.
- **D.** Continuous Delivery eliminates unit testing; Continuous Deployment mandates pair programming.



2.9 The Modern Frontier (AI Spec-Driven Process)

*"AI is an amplifier: it amplifies disciplined engineering specifications,
but it equally amplifies careless, chaotic habits."*

”



The Modern Frontier — AI Spec-Driven Process

The newest paradigm in software process engineering: Autonomous AI coding agents generate software at superhuman speed, but must be strictly governed by structured specifications, deterministic sandboxes, and automated verification gates.

”

- **The Generative AI Revolution:**

- Large Language Models (LLMs) can write, debug, and refactor code in seconds.
- **The New Engineering Dilemma:** While LLMs generate code quickly, they suffer from hallucinations, lack global context, and produce subtle logic bugs.

- **Two Divergent AI Processes:**

- **Vibe Coding (Prompt-First Prototyping):** Informal, exploratory, conversational chatting with an LLM. Great for weekend hackathons; dangerous for production systems.
- **Specification-Driven AI (Spec-Driven AI):** Grounding AI agents with formal, structured specifications, architecture boundaries, and automated test harnesses.

Vibe Coding vs. Specification-Driven AI

Dimension	Process 1: Vibe Coding	Process 2: Spec-Driven AI
Core Philosophy	Prompt-first; accept AI outputs on "vibes"	Specification-first; verify against formal gates
Source of Truth	Ephemeral chat dialog & fuzzy prompts	Structured Markdown Specs (<code>SPEC.md</code> , tests)
Verification	Manual visual inspection ("looks good to me")	Automated CI/CD test suites & security gates
Architectural Coherence	Degenerates quickly; high technical debt	Preserved via explicit contracts and schemas
Reproducibility	Low; impossible to reliably reproduce	High; deterministic tasks and recorded state
Best Suited For	Disposable prototypes, UI mockups, hackathons	Enterprise systems, mission-critical backends

The 3-Step Agentic Feedback Loop

- **Step 1: Formal Specification (Human Architect)**
 - Human authors unambiguous requirements, data models, interface schemas, and acceptance test criteria in structured Markdown.
- **Step 2: Autonomous Agent Execution (AI Worker)**
 - Agent analyzes repository context, formulates a step-by-step plan, and implements code in an isolated sandbox.
- **Step 3: Automated Verification & Review (CI Gate + Human)**
 - CI/CD pipeline compiles code, runs unit tests, linter, and regression suite.
 - **Self-Healing Loop:** If tests fail, compiler errors feed back to the agent for automated repair before human review!

4 Golden Principles for AI-Driven Processes

1. Specifications as Single Source of Truth:

- LLMs have short attention spans and forget chat history. Structured files (`SPEC.md`, `ARCHITECTURE.md`) provide persistent context.

2. Deterministic Sandboxes & Automated Verification Gates:

- Never trust raw LLM output without execution. Automated compilers, linters, and unit test suites must validate every change.

3. Small, Testable Incremental Prompts:

- Prompting an AI to "build an entire Amazon clone" yields broken hallucinated code. Break tasks into small vertical slices (TDD style!).

4. Human-in-the-Loop Architectural Governance:

- AI writes the tactical code (Driver); human engineers remain the strategic architects (Navigator).

 ***The New Role of the Software Engineer: You are no longer just a code typist. You are a Systems Architect, Specification Author, and Verification Governor.*** ”

Concept Check Question 14 (CCQ 14)

In modern AI Specification-Driven development, what is the primary role of automated CI/CD verification gates?

- **A.** To prevent human developers from reviewing artificial intelligence output.
- **B.** To enforce deterministic quality, test compliance, and defect containment before AI-generated code merges into production.
- **C.** To convert natural language prompts directly into cloud infrastructure invoices.
- **D.** To replace software specifications with unverified prompt histories.



2.10 Conceptual Recap & References

*"Theory without practice is empty;
practice without theory is blind."* „

Conceptual Recap: Fill-in-the-blank Quiz

Test your mastery across the 9 software process modules:

1. Software processes consist of 4 universal activities: Specification, Design/Implementation, ____, and Evolution.
2. The ____ model organizes testing symmetrically against requirements and design stages.
3. Delivering functional vertical slices is ____, while progressively refining an existing whole is ____.
4. The Agile Manifesto explicitly values ____ over following a plan.
5. In Kanban, the primary mechanism used to expose bottlenecks and optimize flow is limiting ____.
6. Taking shortcuts to ship quickly incurs ____, which degrades future developer velocity.
7. In Extreme Programming, the practice of writing automated tests before production code is ____.
8. In DevOps, the elite performance metrics established by Google are known as the ____ metrics.
9. Grounding AI coding agents with formal markdown documents and automated test harnesses is called ____.

References & Further Reading

- **Ian Sommerville** (2016). *Software Engineering* (10th Edition). Pearson.
- **Kent Beck** (2004). *Extreme Programming Explained: Embrace Change* (2nd Edition). Addison-Wesley.
- **Martin Fowler** (2018). *Refactoring: Improving the Design of Existing Code* (2nd Edition). Addison-Wesley.
- **Ken Schwaber & Jeff Sutherland** (2020). *The Scrum Guide*. [scrumguides.org](https://www.scrumguides.org).
- **Nicole Forsgren, Jez Humble, Gene Kim** (2018). *Accelerate: Building and Scaling High Performing Technology Organizations (DORA)*. IT Revolution.